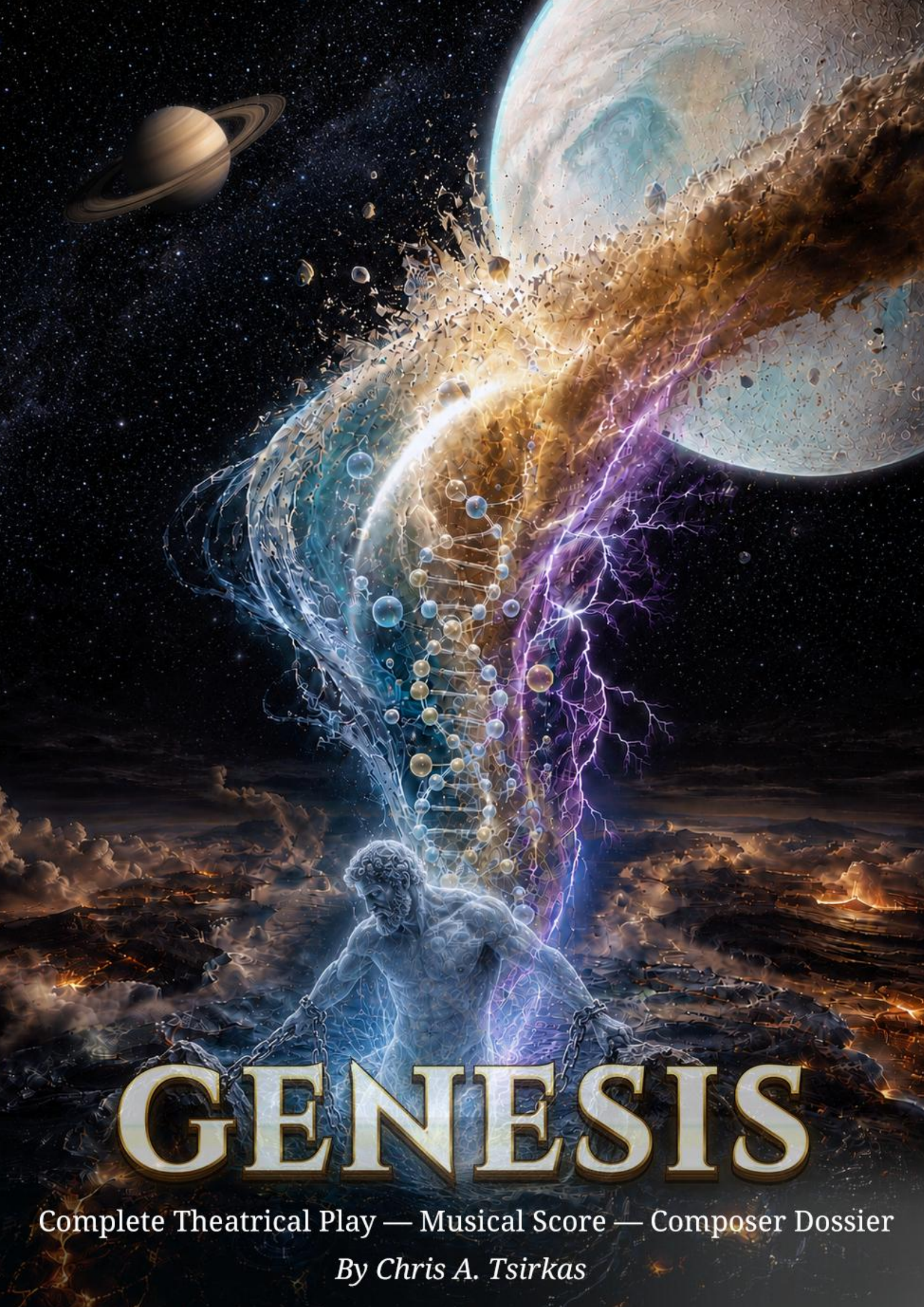




GENESIS

Complete Theatrical Play — Musical Score — Composer Dossier

By Chris A. Tsirkas

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Preface

GENESIS — From Planetary Hypothesis to Drama and Music

“*GENESIS*” began with a question that belongs simultaneously to science and to the oldest territory of human imagination: How does a lifeless world become a living one?

The work presented here is primarily a theatrical and musical response to that question. Its point of departure, however, lies in a speculative scientific investigation of the early Earth: an attempt to imagine, formulate, and examine a planetary event that might have contributed to the environmental and chemical conditions preceding the emergence of life.

That investigation led to the development of a scientific working paper and an accompanying computational framework. Together, they explore a specific hypothesis: that a late, Titan-mass, volatile-rich impactor encountered the Earth approximately 4.1 billion years ago, producing a major environmental reset while contributing water, atmospheric constituents, and chemical feedstocks relevant to prebiotic chemistry. Reduced-order models were developed to examine the internal consistency of this scenario across planetary dynamics, impact partitioning, thermal evolution, atmospheric escape, isotope evolution, noble-gas retention, and post-impact chemistry.

The hypothesis remains provisional. Its calculations do not establish that such an impact occurred, and their calibrated parameters are not measurements of the early Earth. They define a constrained possibility to be tested, refined, or rejected through specialist examination and, ultimately, through higher-fidelity numerical methods. For the time being, the scientific paper and computational framework will not be made publicly available, pending further assessment appropriate to their interdisciplinary scope. They are therefore mentioned here as the intellectual point of departure of “*GENESIS*”, not as evidence required for the understanding or evaluation of the dramatic work.

The theatre therefore begins where calculation can no longer speak. The physical sequence is translated into the language of Myth. Earth becomes once more “*Gaia*”; planetary violence assumes the magnitude of the Titans; “*Necessity*” (“*Ananke*”) becomes both physical law and dramatic power; and “*Prometheus*” becomes more than the traditional bearer of fire. Within the symbolic architecture of the play, he approaches the principle of biological continuity itself: the trace that survives the death of one body, passes beyond the limits of the individual, and is received by another.

This transformation does not attempt to convert scientific speculation into dramatic proof. Nor does it require the audience to accept the planetary hypothesis as historical fact. The scientific inquiry asks what might be calculated, constrained, and tested. The theatrical work asks what such processes might mean when translated into human language: creation through destruction, order emerging from violence, continuity overcoming individual mortality, and life arising not outside nature but from within its laws.

Within this dramatic framework, “*Necessity*” does not signify that the imagined planetary sequence was probable, historically inevitable, or uniquely prescribed by physics. On the contrary, the underlying investigation suggests a narrow and contingent pathway whose realization may have depended upon an extraordinary convergence of circumstances. The drama names that convergence “*Necessity*” because, once imagined as part of the path from which the living world emerged, every unlikely accident becomes an indispensable link in the chain of its existence. What appears accidental before life arises becomes necessary to every living being that comes after it.

Music provides the final dimension of this transformation. The score does not merely accompany the text or illustrate the action; it gives temporal and emotional form to processes whose natural scales extend from seconds of catastrophic impact to thousands of years of planetary cooling and, beyond them, to geological ages of chemical and biological change.

What belongs to physical description as energy, temperature, mass transfer, atmospheric loss, chemical transition, and time becomes, in music, tension, density, rupture, silence, recurrence, transformation, and resolution. The orchestra does not reproduce the planetary event; it renders perceptible its dramatic pressure: the passage from violence to stillness, from dissolution to structure, and from an apparently lifeless silence to the first possibility of memory.

The resulting work may therefore be understood through four related questions:

The scientific hypothesis asks whether such an event could have happened.

The computational model asks whether its proposed consequences can be made quantitatively self-consistent.

The theatrical play asks what such a genesis means.

The music asks what such a genesis sounds like.

These questions arise from the same act of inquiry, but they do not belong to the same system of proof. No part is intended to substitute for another. The dramatic and musical work stands independently of the eventual scientific fate of the hypothesis from which it began.

One Question, Several Languages

For millennia, cosmogony belonged principally to Myth, Philosophy, Poetry, and Religion. Modern science gave humanity another language in which to ask how worlds form, how atmospheres change, how molecules organize, and under what conditions matter may cross the extraordinary threshold into life.

“*GENESIS*” places these languages beside one another, without attempting to erase their differences.

When Prometheus appears on the stage, he does not become an argument for a planetary model. When physical processes are transformed into Gaia, Necessity, Death, or the Chorus of Nights, they cease to function as scientific propositions, and enter the autonomous territory of dramatic meaning. Likewise, the existence of a quantitative foundation does not diminish Prometheus into an equation, Gaia into a planet, or Myth into an ornament placed over scientific machinery.

Theatre does not verify the hypothesis; it reveals another order of consequence.

The catastrophe at the center of the work is therefore more than an imagined collision in the Hadean past. It becomes the primal contradiction from which the drama proceeds: destruction as the condition of creation; death as the bearer of continuity; blind physical law as the distant origin of consciousness; and matter, once incapable of memory, becoming something that can inherit, suffer, speak, and remember.

The deeper subject of “*GENESIS*” is transition:

From collision to order;

From fire to water;

From atmosphere to chemistry;

From chemistry to inheritance;

From matter to life;

From physical event to human meaning;

And, finally, from calculation to word and sound.

The scientific hypothesis may eventually survive and published, change substantially, or be falsified by better evidence. That possibility belongs naturally to the inquiry from which the work arose. The artistic question neither depends upon nor disappears with any future scientific verdict:

How does a world become capable of remembering itself?

“*GENESIS*” is an attempt to ask that question through Myth, theatre, and music—while preserving, beneath them, the distant trace of the scientific question from which they emerged.

Accompanying material

The theatrical and musical work presented in this document forms part of the wider “*GENESIS*” project. The speculative planetary scenario from which this work originated has also been explored through a separate scientific working paper of a falsifiable quantitative hypothesis and a computational framework, including quantitative models, numerical experiments, and an examination of the hypothesis’s limitations. These research materials are not publicly distributed at Zenodo due to the paper’s speculative nature, but remain available for exploration at my GitHub account:

<https://github.com/ChristosTsirkas/genesis-earth-hadean-titan-impact-model>

<https://github.com/ChristosTsirkas/genesis-earth-hadean-titan-impact-model/tree/main/docs>

Additional, computer-generated support files for the music of this project can be accessed at:

<https://github.com/ChristosTsirkas/genesis-earth-hadean-titan-impact-model/tree/main/music>

A rendered realization of the “*GENESIS*” musical score is also available online, allowing the musical component to be heard independently of a staged performance.

Listen to “GENESIS” on SoundCloud:

<https://soundcloud.com/chris-t-331652374>

Genesis – The play

ΠΡΟΛΟΓΟΣ

ΣΕΛΗΝΗ

- 1 Γαῖ', ὦ παλαιὰ μητρὲρ αἵματοσταγές
-- ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ x
- 2 πυρὸς γάμοισι δευτέρὸν σε νῦν βλέπω
~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -
- 3 τέρας κυοῦσαν, ὦ μέγιστον, οὐρανῶ·
~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -
- 4 ἐγὼ γὰρ ἐκ σπλάγχχνων ἀνηρπάσθην ποτε,
~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ ~
- 5 Θείας ὑπὸ πληγῇ βιαίᾳ φλεγομένη.
-- ~ - | -- ~ - | - ~ ~ ~ -
- 6 Νυκτὸς λίθος περιδρομος, ἔφυν μόνη·
~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -
- 7 νεκρὰ νεκρᾶς μητρὸς φύλαξ αἰεὶ μένω·
~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -
- 8 ἔτη δ' ἀμέτρητ' ἄνδρὸν σου σῶμα ἦν·
~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -
- 9 ἔβλεπον, ἄκαρπον λᾶαν ἐμπύρου χθονός,
- ~ ~ ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ ~
- 10 πυρὸς πνοῶν φέρουσαν, ὦ πέτρα, σποράν.
~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -
- 11 Τίς οὗτος ἔρπει νῦν ἀπ' ἐσχάτων μυχῶν
~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ -
- 12 Κρόνου, παλαιῶν ἐδράνων ὀρμώμενος,
~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ ~
- 13 λευκὸς μὲν ὄψει, δυστυχῆς δ' ὁδοιπόρος;
-- ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ ~
- 14 οὐκ ἄστρον· ἀλλὰ σῶμα ἀστραπὴν φέρων,
-- ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ -

PROLOGUE

SELENE

- 1 Earth, ancient mother, drenched once more in
flowing blood,
-- ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ x
- 2 I see you wed a second time now to the fire,
~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -
- 3 And bear for heaven a most monstrous living
birth;
~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -
- 4 For I was torn once from the womb that carried
me,
~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ ~
- 5 Scorched by the ruthless stroke of Theia's violent
hand.
-- ~ - | -- ~ - | - ~ ~ ~ -
- 6 Alone I rose, Night's circling stone around the
Earth,
~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -
- 7 As a dead guard, forever of a mother dead.
~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -
- 8 Through countless years, your body thirsted
without rain;
~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -
- 9 I watched you, barren stone of fire-scorched
earth, for so long;
- ~ ~ ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ ~
- 10 O rock, you bore the seed of hot fire-breathing
winds.
~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -
- 11 Who comes this way from heaven's farthest
hidden depths,
~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ -
- 12 Now plunging down from Cronus' ancient seats
of old
~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ ~
- 13 —White to the eye, yet wretched on his long,
doomed road?
-- ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ ~
- 14 No star, but flesh that bears the flash of lightning
fire;
-- ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ -

- 15 βραδὺς μὲν ὄψει, τῇ δὲ μοίρᾳ ὥκὺς αὖ·
 ~ _ ~ - | ~ _ ~ - | ~ _ ~ -
- 16 πάγῳ πεπηγὼς νῶτα, βαρὺ πνεῦμ' ἔχει,
 ~ _ ~ _ _ ~ ~ ~ ~ ~ ~ ~ ~ ~ ~
- 17 φέρει δ' ὕδωρ σοι νυκτὸς ἐντὸς εἰργμένον,
 ~ _ ~ - | - - ~ - | ~ _ ~ ~
- 18 ὕδωρ, παλαιὸν κτῆμα δυσχείμου χθονός.
 ~ _ ~ - | - - ~ - | - - ~ x
- 19 οὐκ ἔρχεται· πίπτει γὰρ οὐχ ἐκὼν πέσει,
 - - ~ - | - - ~ - | ~ _ ~ -
- 20 χωρεῖ δέ· τίς δ' ἄγει νιν; οὐ θεῶν χέρα·
 - - ~ - | ~ _ ~ - | ~ _ ~ ~
- 21 θεοὺς Ἀνάγκη πάντας ἐν ζυγῷ κρατεῖ,
 ~ _ ~ - | ~ _ ~ - | ~ _ ~ -
- 22 οὐδεὶς δὲ δεσμὸν τόνδε ἐκφεύγει βροτῶν·
 - - ~ - | - - ~ - | - - ~ -
- 23 οὐδ' ἄστρα φεύγει, οὐδὲ γηγενῶν γένος.
 - - ~ - | - - ~ - | ~ _ ~ ~
- 24 ὦ Γαῖα, δευτέρον γε νυμφίον δέχου,
 - - ~ - | ~ _ ~ - | ~ _ ~ -
- 25 ξένον φονέα, πάγον φέροντα πρὸς χθόνα.
 ~ _ ~ ~ ~ | ~ _ ~ - | - - ~ ~
- 26 πρῶτος δὲ σὼν σπλάγχνων βάθος διέσχισεν
 - - ~ - | - - ~ - | - - ~ ~
- 27 —ἐγέννα μ' αὐτὴ Νύξ θυγατέρ' ἐκ σκοτοῦ—,
 ~ _ ~ - | ~ _ ~ - | ~ _ ~ -
- 28 ὁ δεύτερος τὰμνει δέ· τί δὲ τέξεται
 ~ _ ~ - | ~ _ ~ - | ~ _ ~ -
- 29 οὐκ οἶδα· Μοῖρα ταῦτα κρύπτει ἐν σκοτῶ.
 - - ~ - | ~ _ ~ - | ~ _ ~ -

(κτύπος μέγας· σκότος)

- 15 To sight he moves slow; yet his fate has made him
 swift.
 ~ _ ~ - | ~ _ ~ - | ~ _ ~ -
- 16 His back is bound in ice; his heavy breath hangs
 low.
 ~ _ ~ _ _ ~ ~ ~ ~ ~ ~ ~ ~ ~ ~
- 17 He brings you water, locked within the womb of
 night
 ~ _ ~ - | - - ~ - | ~ _ ~ ~
- 18 —Water, the ancient treasure of a wintry soil.
 ~ _ ~ - | - - ~ - | - - ~ x
- 19 He does not come; against his will he falls to you;
 - - ~ - | - - ~ - | ~ _ ~ -
- 20 He moves; what drives him onward? Not the
 hand of gods;
 - - ~ - | ~ _ ~ - | ~ _ ~ ~
- 21 Necessity holds all the gods beneath her yoke;
 ~ _ ~ - | ~ _ ~ - | ~ _ ~ -
- 22 No mortal ever flees the bond she has imposed;
 - - ~ - | - - ~ - | - - ~ -
- 23 Nor stars escape, nor any race born from the
 land.
 - - ~ - | - - ~ - | ~ _ ~ ~
- 24 O Earth, receive your second bridegroom to your
 breast
 - - ~ - | ~ _ ~ - | ~ _ ~ -
- 25 —A stranger and a slayer, bearing ice to your
 ground.
 ~ _ ~ ~ ~ | ~ _ ~ - | - - ~ ~
- 26 The first one cleft the deepest chamber of your
 womb
 - - ~ - | - - ~ - | - - ~ ~
- 27 —Night bore me from the dark, her daughter and
 your own.
 ~ _ ~ - | ~ _ ~ - | ~ _ ~ -
- 28 The second cleaves you; what then shall the blade
 bring forth?
 ~ _ ~ - | ~ _ ~ - | ~ _ ~ -
- 29 I know not; Fate hides things within the dark
 - - ~ - | ~ _ ~ - | ~ _ ~ -

(a great crash; darkness.)

ΠΑΡΟΔΟΣ

ΧΟΡΟΣ ΝΥΚΤΩΝ

ΠΡΟΩΔΟΣ

- 30 ἔπεσεν, ἔπεσεν·
~ ~ ~ ~ ~
- 31 οὐρανὸς οὐρανὸν ἔρρηξεν,
- x ~ - x ~ - - ~
- 32 πέτρα δὲ πέτρα
x x ~ x | -
- 33 συνήντησεν ὀργᾷ.
x | - - ~ - | -
- 34 ἰὼ Γαῖα, Γαῖα,
x | - - x - | x
- 35 πάλιν ἐδέξω πληγάν,
x x ~ - | - - x
- 36 πάλιν δὲ σπλάγχνα
x - | - - x
- 37 πυρὶ διαρραγέντα.
x x x - | x - x
- 38 ἔβρασε γαῖα·
x x ~ - | x
- 39 πάγος δ' ἀπέθανεν,
x - x ~ x | ~
- 40 θανὼν δ' ὕδωρ ἐγένετο,
x - x - | ~ ~ ~ ~
- 41 ξένου θανάτου
~ - x x | -
- 42 πολύδακρυς γονά.
~ x x - | ~ x
- 43 ὃς ψυχρὸς ἦλθεν
- x ~ - | ~
- 44 πῦρ ἐγέννησεν·
- ~ - - ~
- 45 πυρὶ δὲ λυθείς,
x x ~ x | -
- 46 πόντον ἔτεκεν.
- ~ ~ ~ | ~

PARODOS

CHORUS OF NIGHTS

PRELUDE

- 30 It has fallen, fallen;
~ ~ ~ ~ ~
- 31 Sky has torn the sky, in rage, apart;
- x ~ - x ~ - - ~
- 32 Rock crashed against rock,
x x ~ x | -
- 33 In a thunderous rage.
x | - - ~ - | -
- 34 Ah Earth, Earth, wounded Earth,
x | - - x - | x
- 35 Once more you welcomed the blow;
x x ~ - | - - x
- 36 Once more your deep womb
x - | - - x
- 37 Was torn wide apart by flame.
x x x - | x - x
- 38 The ground seethed in fire,
x x ~ - | x
- 39 And the ice died away;
x - x ~ x | ~
- 40 And dying there, turned to water:
x - x - | ~ ~ ~ ~
- 41 From the stranger's doom
~ - x x | -
- 42 Sprang a birth rich in tears.
~ x x - | ~ x
- 43 Frigid he who came,
- x ~ - | ~
- 44 Yet he fathered fire;
- ~ - - ~
- 45 Loosed and slain by flame,
x x ~ x | -
- 46 He brought forth the sea.
- ~ ~ ~ | ~

ΣΤΡΟΦΗ

- 47 ἰὼ ἔρεβος, παλαιάτατον πάντων
 ~ - ~ ~ - | ~ - ~ - | - -
- 48 —πρὶν φέγγος ἀμέρας ἐγένετό ποτε,
 - - ~ - ~ - | ~ ~ ~ ~ ~ x
- 49 πρὶν πόντον μορφὴν λαβεῖν,
 - - - - - ~ -
- 50 πρὶν χθόνα κλῆσιν Γαίας λαβεῖν—,
 - ~ - - - - ~ -
- 51 σὺ πάντ' ἀποκρύπτεις
 ~ - ~ x - -
- 52 καὶ πάντα τρέφεις·
 - - x ~ -
- 53 οὐ γὰρ ἐν φωτὶ τὰ πρῶτα φύεται,
 - ~ - - ~ x - ~ ~ ~ -
- 54 ἀλλ' ἐν μυχῶν ἀφανοῖς θαλάμοις.
 - - ~ - ~ ~ - ~ ~ -
- 55 ἐν σπλάγχνοις ὄντα γεννᾷς,
 - - - - ~ - -
- 56 ἐν νυκτὶ πρώτῃ τε καὶ ἀφεγγεῖ,
 - - ~ x - ~ ~ ~ -
- 57 ἔνθα τὸ μηδὲν ἔτι
 - ~ ~ - ~ ~ x
- 58 πρὸς τὸ γενέσθαι χωρεῖ.
 - ~ ~ - - - -

ΑΝΤΙΣΤΡΟΦΗ

- 59 ἰὼ πέλαγος, νεώτατον πάντων
 ~ - ~ ~ - | ~ - ~ - | - -
- 60 ἐκ τῆς ξένου φθορᾶς σύ ποτε γέγονας,
 - - ~ - ~ - | ~ ~ ~ ~ ~ x
- 61 ῥεῦμα ψυχρὸν γῇ ἄγον.
 - - - - - ~ -
- 62 ἐς χθόνα πνεῦμα ζωῆς φέρεις·
 - ~ - - - - ~ -
- 63 σὺ σπέρμ' ἀποκεύθεις,
 ~ - ~ x - -
- 64 καὶ Γαῖαν τρέφεις.
 - - - ~ -
- 65 οὐ γὰρ ἐν φωτὶ ἡ ρίζα φύεται,
 - ~ - - ~ - ~ ~ ~ -

STROPHE

- 47 O Erebus, most ancient being of all
 ~ - ~ ~ - | ~ - ~ - | - -
- 48 —Before the light of day had ever come to be,
 - - ~ - ~ - | ~ ~ ~ ~ ~ x
- 49 Ere the sea had taken form,
 - - - - - ~ -
- 50 Ere earth received the name of Gaia—,
 - ~ - - - - ~ -
- 51 You hide all things from sight
 ~ - ~ x - -
- 52 And nurture all things;
 - - x ~ -
- 53 For primal forms are never born in the light,
 - ~ - - ~ x - ~ ~ ~ -
- 54 But in the unseen chambers of the depths.
 - - ~ - ~ ~ - ~ ~ -
- 55 In your depths, you bring life forth,
 - - - - ~ - -
- 56 Within primeval Night, devoid of light,
 - - ~ x - ~ ~ ~ -
- 57 Where that which is nothing yet
 - | ~ ~ - ~ ~ ~
- 58 Advances into being.
 - ~ ~ - - - -

ANTISTROPHE

- 59 O Sea, the very youngest being of all,
 ~ - ~ ~ - | ~ - ~ - | - -
- 60 From the death of the stranger you once came to
 be,
 - - ~ - ~ - | ~ ~ ~ ~ ~ x
- 61 Bearing a cold stream to Earth!
 - - - - - ~ -
- 62 You bear the breath of life into Earth;
 - ~ - - - - ~ -
- 63 You hide the seed away,
 ~ - ~ x - -
- 64 And nourish Gaia.
 - - - ~ -
- 65 For the root of life grows not within the
 light,
 - ~ - - ~ - ~ ~ ~ -

66 ἀλλ' ἐν βυθῶν σκοτίοις θαλάμοις,

-- ~ _ ~ ~ _ ~ ~ _

67 ἐν καυσταῖς φλεψὶ πόντου,

----- ~ ---

68 ἐν γαστρὶ πλήρει τε καὶ βαθεία,

-- ~ --- ~ _ ~ ---

69 ἔνθα τὸ μὴ ὄν ἔτι

_ ~ ~ _ ~ ~ x

70 πρὸς τὸ βιῶναι χωρεῖ.

_ ~ ~ -----

66 But in the shadowed chambers of the depths,

-- ~ _ ~ ~ _ ~ ~ _

67 In red-hot veins of the Sea,

----- ~ ---

68 Within a womb both brimming and profound,

-- ~ --- ~ _ ~ ---

69 Where that which is not, as yet,

_ ~ ~ _ ~ ~ x

70 Advances into living.

_ ~ ~ -----

ΕΠΕΙΣΟΔΙΟΝ Α΄

ΣΕΛΗΝΗ

- 71 ὁρῶ πάλιν· κοῖλαι γάρ εἰσι γῆς ῥαγαί,
 ~ - ~ - | - - ~ - | ~ - ~ -
- 72 βυθοί δὲ πίμπλονται μέλανος ὕδατος,
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -
- 73 ἀτμός δὲ βαίνει πρὸς πύλας τοῦ αἰθέρος,
 - - ~ - | - - ~ - | - - ~ -
- 74 ψυχθεὶς δὲ πάλιν ἐς χθόνα κατέρχεται.
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -
- 75 οὐρανὸς ἤδη γαῖαν ὑγρῷ νῦν τρέφει
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -
- 76 γαῖα δ' ἀναπνεῖ πρὸς τὸν οὐρανὸν πάλιν.
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -
- 77 ἀλλ' ἦ τίς ἀμφὶ Μητρὸς αὐχένα πέπλος;
 - - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -
- 78 ἄηρ δὲ γλαυκὸς ἐκφανεῖς τὸ νῦν προρρεῖ·
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -
- 79 πνοὴ θανόντος ἐστίν, οὐ νέφος τόδε.
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -
- 80 ζῶσαν δὲ γαῖαν ἀμφιβάλλει δικτύω.
 - - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | - - ~ -

ΧΟΡΟΣ ΝΥΚΤΩΝ

- 81 καὶ φάρμακον πικρόν —πάγος βαθύς— τόδε,
 - - x - | x - x - | x - ~ ~
- 82 ὃ δὴ κέκρυπτο ἐν χρόνοις πολλοῖς κάτω,
 ~ - x - | ~ - ~ - | - - x -
- 83 νῦν ἐς θαλάσσης γαστέρ' ἐμπίπτει ἔσω,
 - - x - | - - ~ - | - - x -

ΣΕΛΗΝΗ

- 84 ἄδηλον· ἄρα κέρδος ἢ κακὸν μένει;
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -

EPISODE I

SELENE

- 71 I see again: the earth is hollowed into caves,
 ~ - ~ - | - - ~ - | ~ - ~ -
- 72 The depths grow full of dark streams of
 blackened water,
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -
- 73 And vapour rises to the gates of upper air,
 - - ~ - | - - ~ - | - - ~ -
- 74 Then, chilled, it falls again upon the waiting
 earth.
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -
- 75 Now heaven feeds the earth with fresh and liquid
 rain,
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -
- 76 And Earth breathes upward to the sky in turn
 once more.
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -
- 77 What azure robe now clasps the neck of Mother
 Earth?
 - - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -
- 78 The newborn azure air now stretches through
 the sky.
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -
- 79 This is the breath of one dead, not a cloud at all;
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -
- 80 It casts a net around the Earth, now come to life.
 - - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | - - ~ -

CHORUS OF NIGHTS

- 81 This bitter poison too, this ice of deepest frost,
 - - x - | x - x - | x - ~ ~
- 82 Which had been hidden below for countless
 years,
 ~ - x - | ~ - ~ - | - - x -
- 83 Now falls into the womb of the unfathomed sea...
 - - x - | - - ~ - | - - x -

SELENE

- 84 ...unseen: will it become a blessing or a curse?
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -

85 πῶς ἐκ θανάτου σπέρμα βίου γίγνεται;
 -- ~ ~ -- ~ ~ --

ΧΟΡΟΣ ΝΥΚΤΩΝ

86 κέρδος δὲ πολλάκις κακοῦ γόνος πέλει,
 -- ~ ~ | x - x - | ~ ~ ~
 87 ἐκ φαρμάκου ἄκος, ἐκ φόνου γόνος βλαστεῖ.
 -- x - | x ~ ~ ~ | ~ ~ ~
 88 τὸ γὰρ βροτοῖσιν ἐχθρὸν ἄλλοθεν λαβὼν
 ~ ~ ~ | x - ~ ~ | ~ ~ x ~
 89 δύναμιν, ἐχθρὸν δ' ὃν φίλον γένοιτό πως.
 x x ~ ~ | -- x - | ~ ~ ~

ΣΕΛΗΝΗ

90 πλὴν βίος οὐπω δὴ πέφαται γε βροτοῖς.
 -- ~ ~ | ~ ~ ~ ~ | ~ ~ ~ ~

ΧΟΡΟΣ ΝΥΚΤΩΝ

91 ζωὴ μὲν οὐ πάρεστι νῦν· σιγὴ μόνον·
 -- ~ ~ | ~ ~ ~ ~ | ~ ~ ~ x
 92 ἤδη τὸ ἄπνουν ὑποσυνάπτεται ἔσω.
 -- ~ ~ | - ~ ~ ~ ~ | ~ ~ ~ ~
 93 γαίης βαθεῖαι φλέβες ἀναπνέουσι πῦρ,
 -- x - | - ~ ~ x x | ~ ~ ~ ~
 94 ἄνωθεν αὖ πίπτουσιν ἀστραπαὶ κάτω.
 x - ~ ~ | -- ~ ~ | x - x -
 95 δεσμὸς χωρισθέντα συναρμόζει μέρη,
 ----- x x ----- ~ ~
 96 μορφὴν δ' ἄμορφον εἰς αἰὲ χωρεῖ νέαν.
 -- x - | ~ ~ x - | -- ~ ~ x

ΣΕΛΗΝΗ

97 τίς τ᾽ ἄψυχον δεσμούς ἐδίδαξε πλέκειν,
 ~ ~ ~ ~ | ~ ~ ~ ~ | ~ ~ ~ ~

85 How does the seed of living spring up out of death?
 -- ~ ~ -- ~ ~ --

CHORUS OF NIGHTS

86 For blessing often issues from an evil womb;
 -- ~ ~ | x - x - | ~ ~ ~
 87 From poison, cure; from slaughter, a wondrous living birth.
 -- x - | x ~ ~ ~ | ~ ~ ~
 88 For what is hostile to mankind, when gaining might
 ~ ~ ~ | x - ~ ~ | ~ ~ x ~
 89 May turn from foe to friend, through strength received elsewhere.
 x x ~ ~ | -- x - | ~ ~ ~

SELENE

90 But life has not appeared as yet to mortal men.
 -- ~ ~ | ~ ~ ~ ~ | ~ ~ ~ ~

CHORUS OF NIGHTS

91 Life? No; there is but silence reigning here and now;
 -- ~ ~ | ~ ~ ~ ~ | ~ ~ ~ x
 92 Already, the breathless matter is binding within
 -- ~ ~ | - ~ ~ ~ ~ | ~ ~ ~ ~
 93 The deepest veins of earth breathe forth their undying fire,
 -- x - | - ~ ~ x x | ~ ~ ~ ~
 94 And lightning bolts keep falling from the heights above.
 x - ~ ~ | -- ~ ~ | x - x -
 95 A bond now joins the severed parts in one accord,
 ----- x x ----- ~ ~
 96 The formless moves eternally to form anew.
 -- x - | ~ ~ x - | -- ~ ~ x

SELENE

97 Who taught the lifeless thing to weave its hidden bonds?
 ~ ~ ~ ~ | ~ ~ ~ ~ | ~ ~ ~ ~

98 μνήμην ἔδωκεν τίς ποτ' οὐδὲν εἰδότε,

-- ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ x

99 τίς αὖ τὸ μὴ ῥέον γ' ἔπει σε ῥεῖν πάλιν,

~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ x

100 τὸ ταὐτὸν αὖ ποιεῖν τε καὶ γεννᾶν ἔτι;

~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ -

(ἡ ΑΝΑΓΚΗ ἐκ τοῦ σκότους φαίνεται.)

ΑΝΑΓΚΗ

101 Ἀνάγκη· νῦν δ' ἤκω· τί χρήζεις δὴ ἐμοῦ;

~ ---- | -- ~ - | -- ~ -

ΣΕΛΗΝΗ

102 σὺ πάντα δεσμοῖς ἀλύτοις ἔχεις χθονί.

-- ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ x

ΑΝΑΓΚΗ

103 ἐγὼ δὲ δεσμοὺς οὐκ ἐποίησα τινάς.

~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ -

104 οὐ θυμὸν ἴσχω, χεῖρ' ἀνασχεῖν οὐ θέλω,

-- ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ -

105 οὐδ' ὥς δικαστὴς πράγματα κρίνω τάδε.

-- ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ ~

106 ὅταν δὲ θερμὸν ψυχρὸν ἀντήσῃ δρόμῳ,

~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ -

107 ὅταν τὸ βαρὺ πρὸς τὸ κοῖλον ἐμπέσῃ,

~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ -

108 ὅταν δὲ δεσμὸς ἄλλον ἐκ δεσμοῦ τέκῃ,

~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | -- ~ -

109 ἰδοῦ, ξένον τι φαίνεται. ὦ Γῆ, σιγᾶς;

~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | -- ~ -

ΓΑΙΑ

110 οὐκ οἶδα· δεινὸν δ' ἐν βυθοῖς αἰσθάνομαι.

-- ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ -

98 Who gave it memory, though knowing nothing yet?

-- ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ x

99 Who taught the motionless to flow and move once more?

~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ x

100 And do the same, and still beget the same once more?

~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ -

(NECESSITY appears from the darkness.)

NECESSITY

101 Necessity is here. What do you need from me?

~ ---- | -- ~ - | -- ~ -

SELENE

102 You hold all things on earth in bonds none can unloose.

-- ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ x

NECESSITY

103 I did not fashion any bonds at all myself.

~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ -

104 I have no will, nor wish to raise a ruling hand;

-- ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ -

105 Nor do I judge these deeds as one enthroned by Law.

-- ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ ~

106 When heat and cold confront each other in their course,

~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ -

107 When heavy matter plunges in the hollow void,

~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ -

108 When one bond gives another bond its birth in turn,

~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | -- ~ -

109 Behold, some strange thing now appears. Earth, why so still?

~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | -- ~ -

EARTH

110 I know not; terror stirs in depths below,

-- ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ -

111 ὥς οὐρανὸς βαρὺς κατέρχεται χθονί.

-- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

112 τί δ' ἐστίν; ἄρα πῦρ ἀναρρήξει χθόνα;

-- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ -

ΑΝΑΓΚΗ

113 τί δῆτα τοῦτο καινὸν ἐν κόσμῳ πέλει;

-- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ -

ΣΕΛΗΝΗ

114 ἐκ τοῦ θανόντος σὺ νέον βίον φύεις.

-- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ -

115 ποτ' αὖ, θεά, νέον γόνον πρὸς φῶς φέρεις;

˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ -

ΑΝΑΓΚΗ

116 νῦν ἐν βυθῷ τι καινὸν αὐξάνει γονήν,

-- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ -

117 μυρία τίκτεται γε, παῦρα δ' αὐξάνει,

-- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ -

118 ζήσαντ' δὲ πολλὰ, οὐδὲν ἐκλείπει γένος·

-- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ ˘

119 πολλὰ δὲ, λαβόντα γε μορφὴν πρὸς χρόνον,

-- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ ˘

120 ῥήσεται εἰς νῦν αὖθις ἄμορφον γένος.

-- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ ˘

121 τὸ σωθὲν αὖ σωτηρίας νόμον φέρει.

˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

122 μόνον δ' ὃ διπλοῦται χρόνον πλέον λαβεῖν·

˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

123 ὃ δ' ἂν σφαλῇ γεννῶν ἑαυτὸ τοῦθ' ὅπερ,

˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ ˘

124 ἄλλον δὲ φύσει· κάκ νέου πλῆθος βλαστεῖ.

-- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ -

111 Now, as the heavy sky sinks down upon my
ground.

-- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

112 What can this be? Will the fire burst my soil
apart?

-- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ -

NECESSITY

113 And now, what new thing has arisen in the
world?

-- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ -

SELENE

114 Out of the thing that died, you make new life
arise.

-- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ -

115 Will you, O goddess, bring new offspring forth to
light?

˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ -

NECESSITY

116 There, deep within, some newborn seed now
waxes strong;

-- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ -

117 Myriads of creatures come to birth, yet few will
thrive.

-- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ -

118 And indeed many live; no race dies out entire.

-- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ ˘

119 And many still, having held their form a while,

-- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ ˘

120 No doubt, will flow once more into a formless
kind;

-- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ ˘

121 Whatever has been saved bears on the law that
saved.

˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

122 And now, that which divides alone shall gain
more time;

˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

123 But then that which will err while birthing its
own self,

˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ ˘

124 will bear another; from the new, a host shall
spring.

-- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ -

ΧΟΡΟΣ ΝΥΚΤΩΝ

125 τὸ σφάλμα δ' ἄρα κόσμον ἀλλάξει ποτέ;
 -- x - | x - ~ - | -- ~ ~

ΑΝΑΓΚΗ

126 ἴσον τι γεννᾷ τὰκριβὲς γ' αὐτῷ πάλιν·
 ~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ x

127 οὕτως ἀμείβει κόσμος αὐτὸν ἐν χρόνῳ.
 -- ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ -

128 ἔριν φέρει πλῆθος· κρίσιν δ' ἔρις φέρει·
 ~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ -

129 διακρίνει πάντ' ἀφανίζει δ' αὖ χρόνος
 -- ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ ~

ΣΕΛΗΝΗ

130 δεινὰ προφωνεῖς, ὦ φίλη, βροτοῖς τάδε.
 -- ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ ~

ΑΝΑΓΚΗ

131 δεινότερα δ' ὄψει τάδε σύ, φίλη, ποτέ·
 - ~ ~ ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ ~

132 ἔσται γὰρ ἡμαρ ἡνίκ' ἂν τόδ' ὁ βλέπεις,
 -- ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ -

133 ἄφωνον, ἄφοβον, μικρόν, ἀγνοοῦν, τυφλόν
 -- ~ - | ~ - ~ ~ ~ | ~ - ~ ~

134 πληροῖ δὲ πόντον μυρίοις γε ἐκγόνοις,
 -- ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ -

135 καὶ τοῦτ' ἐκείνου βρῶμα, κεῖνο τοῦδε δ' αὖ.
 -- ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ -

ΧΟΡΟΣ ΝΥΚΤΩΝ

136 φόνος γένοιτ' ἂν τοῦτο τοῖς βροτοῖς, τάχα;
 ~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - x x

CHORUS OF NIGHTS

125 Will error ever change the order of the world?
 -- x - | x - ~ - | -- ~ ~

NECESSITY

126 The true begets its like: the same form lives
 anew;
 ~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ x-

127 In truth, thus through long time the World
 transforms itself.
 -- ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ -

128 From many, there comes strife; fierce strife
 brings judgment forth;
 ~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ -

129 So, then, time sifts all things, then makes all
 things unseen.
 -- ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ ~

SELENE

130 Dear one, you foretell dread things for the
 mortal kind.
 -- ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ ~

NECESSITY

131 But you, dear friend, shall one day see still far
 greater dread.
 - ~ ~ ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ ~

132 There shall arise a day when this which now you
 see,
 -- ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ -

133 As yet, voiceless and blind, small, fearless,
 knowing naught,
 -- ~ - | ~ - ~ ~ ~ | ~ - ~ ~

134 —This thing— shall fill the sea with countless
 broods of young;
 -- ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ -

135 And each shall feed upon the other, turn by turn.
 -- ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ -

CHORUS OF NIGHTS

136 Should then the mortals call but “murder” this
 dark deed?
 ~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - x x

ΑΝΑΓΚΗ

- 137 πρὶν ἂν νόμος φύῃ; λέγω, τόδ' οὐ κυρεῖ·
 -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -
- 138 φόνος γὰρ οὐκ ἔνεστι πρὶν φῦναι νόμον.
 ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ ˘

ΣΕΛΗΝΗ

- 139 ἔσται δὲ τοῖς βροτοῖσι καὶ νόμος τάχα;
 -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

ΑΝΑΓΚΗ

- 140 μνήμη γὰρ αὖ τίκτει φόβον βροτοῖς ἀεί·
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -
- 141 φόβος φυγὴν τίκτει, φυγὴ βουλὴν φέρει·
 ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ -
- 142 ὅταν δὲ βουλὴ σώματος λάβῃ κράτος,
 ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ ˘
- 143 τότε ἄρχεται τὸ δεινὸν ἐν βροτοῖς κακόν.
 ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

ΧΟΡΟΣ ΝΥΚΤΩΝ

- 144 ποῖον λέγεις;
 -- ˘ -

ΑΝΑΓΚΗ

- 145 ὁ βίος αὐτός ἐστι δῆ.
 ˘ ˘ ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

NECESSITY

- 137 Ere law is born? I say, such crime does not exist.
 -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -
- 138 For indeed murder cannot be, ere law is born.
 ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ ˘

SELENE

- 139 Will mortal kind then come to have a law as well?
 -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

NECESSITY

- 140 For memory once more gives birth to fear in man;
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -
- 141 Now, fear births flight, and flight brings forth the seed of thought;
 ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ -
- 142 And once the mind has gained dominion over flesh,
 ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ ˘
- 143 Then dread begins to make its home in mortal kind.
 ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

CHORUS OF NIGHTS

- 144 What dread is that?
 -- ˘ -

NECESSITY

- 145 Why, none but life itself, I say.
 ˘ ˘ ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

ΣΤΑΣΙΜΟΝ Α΄

ΧΟΡΟΣ ΝΥΚΤΩΝ

ΣΤΡΟΦΗ

- 146 ἰὼ νεογενὲς σπέρμα τοῦ βυθοῦ
 ~ _ ~ ~ ~ _ | _ ~ _ ~ _
- 147 ἄγνωστον, ἀφανές,
 _ _ ~ ~ ~ | ~
- 148 οὐπὼ ζῶον οὔτε φυτόν,
 _ _ _ ~ | _ ~ ~ x
- 149 οὔτε γένος οὔτ' ὄνομα φέρον,
 _ ~ ~ ~ | _ ~ ~ _ | ~ x
- 150 τίς σ' ἐκάλεσ' ἐκ νυκτός γε;
 _ ~ ~ ~ | _ _ _ x
- 151 τίς ποτ' ἐκ φθορᾶς
 _ ~ _ ~ _
- 152 πρὸς φῶς ὁδὸν ἤνοιξέ τοι;
 _ _ ~ ~ _ ~ ~
- 153 οὐ μήτηρ σ' ἔτεκεν
 _ _ _ ~ ~ _
- 154 οὐ πατὴρ σπορά,
 _ | _ _ ~ _
- 155 οὐ θεοῦ χεὶρ ἔπλασέ σε·
 _ ~ _ _ | ~ x ~ _
- 156 ὕδωρ τε πῦρ τε καὶ πέτρα,
 ~ _ ~ _ | ~ _ ~ _
- 157 φάρμακόν τε πικρόν,
 _ ~ _ ~ ~ _
- 158 δεσμοὺς ἀδήλους συντιθέντα πως
 _ _ ~ _ _ | _ ~ _ ~ _
- 159 σ' ἐγέννησαν.
 ~ _ _ ~

ΑΝΤΙΣΤΡΟΦΗ

- 160 ἰὼ νεογενὲς τέκνον ἐκ χθονός
 ~ _ ~ ~ ~ _ | _ ~ _ ~ _
- 161 ἄγνωστον, ἀμαθές,
 _ _ ~ ~ ~ | ~

STASIMON I

CHORUS OF NIGHTS

STROPHE

- 146 Ah newborn spore, you small child of the dark
 ~ _ ~ ~ ~ _ | _ ~ _ ~ _
 deep
- 147 —Born unknown and unseen,
 _ _ ~ ~ ~ | ~
- 148 And not yet beast nor yet green plant,
 _ _ _ ~ | _ ~ ~ x
- 149 Still, of no race, nor bearing a true name—,
 _ ~ ~ ~ | _ ~ ~ _ | ~ x
- 150 Who summoned you from night's dark womb?
 _ ~ ~ ~ | _ _ _ x
- 151 Who, then, from decay,
 _ ~ _ ~ _
- 152 Opened for you a road to light?
 _ _ ~ ~ _ ~ ~
- 153 No mother gave you birth,
 _ _ _ ~ ~ _
- 154 Nor seed of father;
 _ | _ _ ~ _
- 155 No hand of god fashioned your form;
 _ ~ _ _ | ~ x ~ _
- 156 But water, flame, and stone as one,
 ~ _ ~ _ | ~ _ ~ _
- 157 And bitter poison too
 _ ~ _ ~ ~ _
- 158 —Forming unseen bonds somehow into one —
 _ _ ~ _ _ | _ ~ _ ~ _
- 159 They gave you birth.
 ~ _ _ ~

ANTISTROPHE

- 160 Ah newborn child, sprung from the womb of the
 ~ _ ~ ~ ~ _ | _ ~ _ ~ _
 earth,
- 161 Unknown, untaught, and still
 _ _ ~ ~ ~ | ~

162 οὐπω πόνον οὔτε χαρὰν,
 -- ˘ ˘ | -- ˘ ˘

163 οὔτε φόβον οὔτε πόθον φέρον,
 -- ˘ ˘ ˘ | -- ˘ ˘ -- | ˘ x

164 τίς ἔθετό σοι μνήμην αὖ;
 -- ˘ ˘ ˘ | --- x

165 τίς ποτ' ἐξ ἑνός
 -- ˘ -- ˘ --

166 τὸ δεύτερον ἐξήγαγέ σε;
 ˘ _ ˘ ˘ _ _ ˘ ˘ _

167 οὐ θεσμός σ' ἔνεμεν
 --- ˘ ˘ _

168 οὐ Μοίρας γραφή,
 -- | -- ˘ --

169 οὐ θεοῦ νοῦς ἔταξέ σε·
 -- ˘ -- | ˘ x ˘ --

170 χρόνος τύχη τε καὶ χρεία
 ˘ -- ˘ -- | ˘ ---

171 σφάλμα καὶ γόνιμον,
 -- ˘ -- ˘ ˘ --

172 δεσμούς ἀδήλους διαβαίνοντα δῆ,
 -- ˘ -- | ˘ ˘ -- ˘ --

173 σὲ γ' ἠϋξησαν.
 ˘ _ _

ΕΠΩΔΟΣ

174 ὦ μέγα θαῦμα τοῦ μικροῦ,
 -- | ˘ x -- x -- | x --

175 ὦ σπέρμα μυρίων γενεῶν,
 -- | -- x x x -- | ˘ ˘ --

176 ἔν ὃν δύο γενήσῃ,
 ˘ -- x ˘ ˘ | --

177 δύο δὲ μυρία.
 x ˘ ˘ x x | x

178 καὶ πόντος οὐκέτι πόντος·
 -- ˘ -- | ˘ x -- ˘

179 μήτρα φανήσεται.
 -- x ˘ -- | ˘ --

180 καὶ Γαῖα οὐκέτι πέτρα·
 -- x -- | ˘ x x x

181 «μήτηρ» κληθήσεται.
 --- ˘ --

162 Now not yet knowing pain or joy,
 -- ˘ ˘ | -- ˘ ˘

163 Having no fear and bearing no desire,
 -- ˘ ˘ ˘ | -- ˘ ˘ -- | ˘ x

164 Who put remembrance in you, then?
 -- ˘ ˘ ˘ | --- x

165 Who, when, out of one,
 -- ˘ -- ˘ --

166 Then, brought forth the second shape of you?
 ˘ _ ˘ ˘ _ _ ˘ ˘ _

167 No law assigned your place,
 --- ˘ ˘ _

168 Nor writing of Fate;
 -- | -- ˘ --

169 No mind of god appointed you;
 -- ˘ -- | ˘ x ˘ --

170 But Time and Chance and Need—all one,
 ˘ -- ˘ -- | ˘ ---

171 And fruitful error too,
 -- ˘ -- ˘ ˘ --

172 Then, passing unseen through bonds that shift
 and change,
 -- ˘ -- | ˘ ˘ -- ˘ --

173 They made you grow.
 ˘ _ _

EPODE

174 Great wonder, sprung from what is small,
 -- | ˘ x -- x -- | x --

175 brood of many countless unborn tribes,
 -- | -- x x x -- | ˘ ˘ --

176 Still, though one, you shall be two;
 ˘ -- x ˘ ˘ | --

177 And two shall be countless.
 x ˘ ˘ x x | x

178 And sea shall be no longer sea,
 -- ˘ -- | ˘ x -- ˘

179 But shall emerge a womb.
 -- x ˘ -- | ˘ --

180 And Earth shall be no longer stone,
 -- x -- | ˘ x x x

181 And then be called “mother”.
 --- ˘ --

182 ἀλλ' ὅπου γένεσις,

— ˘ — | ˘ ˘ ˘

183 ἐκεῖ καὶ φθορά·

˘ — | — ˘ ×

184 ὅπου δὲ πλῆθος,

˘ — × — | ˘

185 ἐκεῖ καὶ θάνατος.

˘ — | — × × ˘

186 ἤδη γὰρ ἕτερός τις

— — × ˘ ˘ | — ×

187 ἐν πύλαις μένει.

— × — | ˘ —

182 Yet wherever birth is,

— ˘ — | ˘ ˘ ˘

183 There, decay shall be.

˘ — | — ˘ ×

184 Where there are many,

˘ — × — | ˘

185 There, death shall also dwell.

˘ — | — × × ˘

186 For now, yet another one

— — × ˘ ˘ | — ×

187 Waits before the gates.

— × — | ˘ —

ΕΠΕΙΣΟΔΙΟΝ Β΄

(ἐκ τοῦ σκούτους ἀναφαίνεται ὁ ΘΑΝΑΤΟΣ.)

ΘΑΝΑΤΟΣ

188 τίς Θάνατον, καινὸν δαίμον' ἐκ γαίας, καλεῖ;
 - ~ - | - - - ~ | - - - ~ -

ΣΕΛΗΝΗ

189 τίς εἶ; τίς ἡ μορφή; τίνος πέρι πάρει;
 - - ~ - | - - ~ - | ~ - ~ -

ΘΑΝΑΤΟΣ

190 οὐκ εἰμι καινός· νῦν δὲ πρῶτον ὄνομ' ἔχω.
 - - ~ - | - - ~ - | ~ ~ ~ ~ -

ΣΕΛΗΝΗ

191 πρὶν ζῶον εἶναι πῶς θανεῖν τι χρῆν ποτέ;
 - - ~ - | - - ~ - | - - ~ ~

ΘΑΝΑΤΟΣ

192 λίθος δὲ θραύεται, τὸ πῦρ δὲ σβέννυται·
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -

193 ὕδωρ δ' ἀτμίζεται· θάνατος δ' οὐκ ἔνι,
 - - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | - - ~ -

194 θανεῖν γὰρ οἷόν τ' ἐστὶ τὸ ζῆσαν μόνον.
 - - ~ - | - - ~ - | - - ~ ~

ΣΕΛΗΝΗ

195 ἦ καὶ σὺ βίῳ ξυνεγένου πρώτη τότε;
 - - ~ - | - ~ ~ ~ - | - - ~ ~

EPISODE II

(DEATH emerges from the darkness.)

DEATH

188 Who summons Death, a newborn spirit, from
 ancient earth?
 - ~ - | - - - ~ | - - - ~ -

SELENE

189 In truth, who are you? What's your form? Why
 have you come?
 - - ~ - | - - ~ - | ~ - ~ -

DEATH

190 I am not new, though now I bear my own first
 true name.
 - - ~ - | - - ~ - | ~ ~ ~ ~ -

SELENE

191 But say, before life was, how could a creature
 die?
 - - ~ - | - - ~ - | - - ~ ~

DEATH

192 The stone is shattered, while the flame is
 quenched at last.
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -

193 And even water turns to steam; there is no
 death;
 - - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | - - ~ -

194 For indeed only what has lived can ever die.
 - - ~ - | - - ~ - | - - ~ ~

SELENE

195 Were you, then, the first to arise together with
 life?
 - - ~ - | - ~ ~ ~ - | - - ~ ~

ΘΑΝΑΤΟΣ

- 196 σκιά πέφυκα σώματος ζώντος πέλας·
 -- ~ - | ~ - ~ - | -- ~ -
- 197 σὺν τῷ βίῳ πέφυκε καὶ μόρος βροτοῖς.
 -- ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -

ΧΟΡΟΣ ΝΥΚΤΩΝ

- 198 οἶμοι· τὸ δῶρον δισσὸν ἦλθε πρὸς χθόνα.
 -- ~ - | -- ~ - | x - ~ x

ΘΑΝΑΤΟΣ

- 199 οὐ πῆμα, οὐδὲ δῶρον· εἰμι γῆς νόμος.
 -- ~ - | ~ - ~ - | -- ~ ~
- 200 εἰ γὰρ τὸ πρῶτον ζῶον οὐ φθαρήσεται,
 -- ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ -
- 201 τὸ δεύτερον ποῦ χώραν ἔξει πρὸς βίον;
 ~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ ~
- 202 εἰ πᾶν τὸ γεννηθὲν μένει παρὸν χρόνον,
 -- ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ ~
- 203 καινῷ γενέσθαι κόσμος οὐ παρέχει τόπον.
 -- ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ ~ - ~ ~

ΣΕΛΗΝΗ

- 204 σὺ δ' οὖν ἀνοίγεις τοῖς ἐπερχομένοις ὁδόν;
 -- ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ ~ - ~ ~

ΘΑΝΑΤΟΣ

- 205 ὃ ζῇ παραχωρεῖ· τὸ δ' ἔπεται λαμβάνει.
 -- ~ - | -- ~ ~ ~ | -- ~ -
- 206 οὕτως ὁ κόσμος οὐ μένει λίθος παγείς,
 -- ~ - | ~ - ~ - | -- ~ -

DEATH

- 196 I am the shadow, bound to live near a live
 corpse;
 -- ~ - | ~ - ~ - | -- ~ -
- 197 With life itself there came the birth of death for
 man.
 -- ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -

CHORUS OF NIGHTS

- 198 And now, alas, a twofold gift has reached the
 earth.
 -- ~ - | -- ~ - | x - ~ x

DEATH

- 199 Know this: no grief, no gift: I am the law of
 earth;
 -- ~ - | ~ - ~ - | -- ~ ~
- 200 Suppose the first-born creature never comes to
 die;
 -- ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ -
- 201 Then say, what place for life remains to greet the
 next?
 ~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ ~
- 202 If all that has been born should last throughout
 all time,
 -- ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ ~
- 203 The world allows no new-born thing a place to
 be here.
 -- ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ ~ - ~ ~

SELENE

- 204 And so you open new roads for those who are to
 come?
 -- ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ ~ - ~ ~

DEATH

- 205 What lives now yields its place; what follows
 takes its own turn.
 -- ~ - | -- ~ ~ ~ | -- ~ -
- 206 No longer does the world remain a stone bound
 fast;
 -- ~ - | ~ - ~ - | -- ~ -

207 ἀλλ' ἄλλο γίγνεται δι' ἄλλου θανάτου.
 -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ -

208 τόδ' ἐστὶ μοῖρα· χρή γενέσθαι καὶ τόδε.
 ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ -

ΧΟΡΟΣ ΝΥΚΤΩΝ

209 τί δῆτά μοι λέγεις ἔτ' ἄλλο; οὐ πλέον;
 ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

ΘΑΝΑΤΟΣ

210 οὐδὲν γὰρ ἄλλο δεῖ με πω λέγειν τόδε.
 -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ ˘

ΑΝΑΓΚΗ

211 καλῶς ἔχει τάδε πάντα σοι· μὴ φροντίσης.
 -- ˘ - | ˘ ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ -

ΓΑΙΑ

212 ἐγὼ δὲ πάντων σώματ' αὖθις δέξομαι.
 ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ -

213 ὃ μὲν θαλάσση ζῇ, τὸ δ' ἐν χέρσῳ ποτέ,
 ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ ˘

214 ὃ δ' ἂν πτερωθὲν αἰθέρος ψαύσῃ δρόμων·
 ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ -

215 ἄνευ φθορᾶς οὐκ ἔστι γέννησις ποτέ.
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ ˘

ΘΑΝΑΤΟΣ

216 σὺ γὰρ πέλεις μήτηρ τε καὶ τάφος βροτῶν.
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ -

ΓΑΙΑ

217 μία γὰρ ἀρχὴ καὶ τελευτὴ τοῖς ἐμοῖς.
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ -

207 Each newborn thing comes through the death of
 what came first.

-- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ -

208 This is the Fate; and this in turn must come to
 pass.

˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ -

CHORUS OF NIGHTS

209 What else have you to tell us now? Is there no
 more?

˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

DEATH

210 No, there is nothing else I need to say as yet.

-- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ ˘

NECESSITY

211 All this is well for you; dismiss all further dark
 thought.

-- ˘ - | ˘ ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ -

EARTH

212 And I myself shall take all bodies back again.

˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ -

213 One shall live in the sea, another on the land;

˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ ˘

214 Another, borne on wings, shall touch the paths
 of air;

˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ -

215 No birth can ever come to be without decay.

-- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ ˘

DEATH

216 For you are both the mother and the tomb of
 men.

-- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ -

EARTH

217 For all my beings, one source and one same end
 remain.

-- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ -

ΣΤΑΣΙΜΟΝ Β΄

ΧΟΡΟΣ ΝΥΚΤΩΝ

ΣΤΡΟΦΗ

- 218 τίς ἂν ἔφρασε τῷ Πόντῳ,
 219 ὅτε πρῶτον δέξατο σπέρμα,
 220 ὅτι μυρίων νεκρῶν
 221 ἀρχὴν ἐδέχετο;
 222 τίς ἂν ἔφρασε Γαίᾳ
 223 ὅτι, μήτηρ γενομένη,
 224 τάφος ἅμα γενήσεται
 225 πάντων ὅσα θρέψει;
 226 ἰὼ δισσοῦν ἔργον τοῦ βίου:
 227 ἡ αὐτὴ χεὶρ
 228 ἀνοίγει μήτραν,
 229 ἀνοίγει δὲ τύμβον.

ΑΝΤΙΣΤΡΟΦΗ

- 230 τίς ἂν ἔφρασε τῇ Νυκτί,
 231 ὅτε πρῶτον δέξατο φέγγος,
 232 ὅτι μυρίων σκιῶν
 233 φῶς αὖ ἐγένετο;
 234 τίς ἂν ἔφρασε Κόσμῳ

STASIMON II

CHORUS OF NIGHTS

STROPHE

- 218 Who could have said unto the Sea,
 219 When first it received a seed of life,
 220 That the law of myriad deaths
 221 Was what it then received?
 222 Who could have addressed the Earth
 223 That, having become a mother,
 224 She would at once become a tomb
 225 For all that she shall rear?
 226 O twofold task, the labour of life:
 227 The one same hand
 228 It opens the womb,
 229 And opens up the tomb.

ANTISTROPHE

- 230 Who could have said unto the Night,
 231 When first it received the gleam of dawn,
 232 That from the myriad shadows
 233 The light was born again?
 234 Who could have addressed the World,

235 ὅτι, πάντ' ἐξαπολέσας,
 ~ ~ _ _ | ~ ~ ~ _

236 τότε ἅμα γενήσεται
 ~ ~ ~ ~ ~ _ ~ _

237 πάντων γε μήτηρ αὖ;
 _ _ ~ _ | _ _

238 ἰὼ δισσὸν ἔργον τοῦ βίου:
 ~ _ _ ~ _ _ _ ~ _

239 ἡ αὐτὴ χεὶρ
 _ _ _ _

240 ἀνοίγει τύμβον,
 ~ _ | _ _ ~

241 ἀνοίγει δὲ μήτραν.
 ~ _ _ ~ _ ~

ΕΠΩΔΟΣ

242 ἀλλ' ἴδε:
 _ ~ x

243 ἤδη τὸ μικρὸν,
 _ _ ~ x | x

244 τὸ πρὶν ἀφανὲς,
 x ~ ~ ~ | x

245 πόντον κατέχει·
 _ | _ ~ ~ _

246 ἤδη τὸ ἓν
 _ | _ ~ x

247 μυρίων γενῶν
 ~ ~ ~ _ ~ _

248 μορφὰς ἀλλάσσει·
 _ _ _ | _ _

249 ἄλλο τὸ φῶς ζητεῖ,
 _ ~ ~ _ _ _

250 ἄλλο βυθὸν φιλεῖ,
 _ | ~ ~ _ ~ _

251 ἄλλο τὸν ἄλλον
 _ | ~ ~ _ x

252 βίον καταβρώσκει.
 ~ _ ~ x | _ _

253 καὶ πόλεμος οὐκ ἔστιν·
 _ ~ ~ ~ _ | _ x

254 πόλεμος δ' ἤδη γίνεται.
 ~ ~ _ _ _ ~ ~ _

235 After it laid all beings waste,
 ~ ~ _ _ | ~ ~ ~ _

236 It then would instantly become
 ~ ~ ~ ~ ~ _ ~ _

237 Mother of all in turn?
 _ _ ~ _ | _ _

238 O twofold task, the labour of life:
 ~ _ _ ~ _ _ _ ~ _

239 The one same hand
 _ _ _ _

240 It opens the tomb,
 ~ _ | _ _ ~

241 And then unseals the womb.
 ~ _ _ ~ _ ~

EPODE

242 Yet behold:
 _ ~ x

243 Now the little thing,
 _ _ ~ x | x

244 That once was unseen,
 x ~ ~ ~ | x

245 Possesses the sea;
 _ | _ ~ ~ _

246 That which was one,
 _ | _ ~ x

247 Through myriad kinds
 ~ ~ ~ _ ~ _

248 Wears form after form;
 _ _ _ | _ _

249 One of the forms seeks light;
 _ ~ ~ _ _ _

250 Another loves the deep;
 _ | ~ ~ _ ~ _

251 One finds another,
 _ | ~ ~ _ x

252 And feeds upon its life.
 ~ _ ~ x | _ _

253 War does not exist as yet;
 _ ~ ~ ~ _ | _ x

254 But war already comes to birth.
 ~ ~ _ _ _ ~ ~ _

ΕΠΕΙΣΟΔΙΟΝ Γ΄

ΣΕΛΗΝΗ

- 255 μακρὸν χρόνον σιγῶσα τήνδε γῆν ὀρῶ.
 -- ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ -
- 256 κύκλῳ περιτρέχω, μεταβολὰς δὲ σκοπῶ.
 -- ~ - | ~ - ~ ~ ~ | -- ~ -
- 257 ὁ πόντος οὐκέτ' ἄψυχος· γένη φέρει·
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -
- 258 ἄλλα πτερὰ φύει πρὸς αἰθέρος δρόμον,
 -- ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ ~
- 259 ἄλλα χθόνα πατεῖ, πρὶν ἄβατον γένος.
 -- ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ ~

ΓΑΙΑ

- 260 καὶ χέρσον ἤδη τοῖς ἔμοις ἀνοίξομαι.
 -- ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ -

ΣΕΛΗΝΗ

- 261 τί φῆς; ἀφήσει πόντον ἢ ζωὴ ποτέ;
 -- ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ ~

ΓΑΙΑ

- 262 πᾶν δὴ δεθὲν βία λύσιν ποθεῖ τινα.
 -- ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ ~

ΑΝΑΓΚΗ

- 263 οὐ δὴ ποθεῖ· φύσις βία πρόσω φέρει.
 -- ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -

ΓΑΙΑ

- 264 ὥς εἰ ποθοῦν βία πρόσω ἐπέρχεται.
 -- ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -

EPISODE III

SELENE

- 255 After long silence, I behold this land again.
 -- ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ -
- 256 I wheel across the heavens, watching all forms
 now change.
 -- ~ - | ~ - ~ ~ ~ | -- ~ -
- 257 The sea, once void of life, now teems with living
 forms;
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -
- 258 Some breathing things grow wings to course the
 upper air,
 -- ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ ~
- 259 While others tread the earth, once barred to
 mortal feet.
 -- ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ ~

EARTH

- 260 And now I'll open land to all my living kinds.
 -- ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ -

SELENE

- 261 In truth, what do you say? Shall life forsake the
 sea?
 -- ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ ~

EARTH

- 262 All that is bound desires to see its bonds undone.
 -- ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ ~

NECESSITY

- 263 It has no wish; its nature carries it along.
 -- ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -

EARTH

- 264 As though it yearned, by force it travels on its
 course.
 -- ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -

ΑΝΑΓΚΗ

265 καλῶς λέγεις· τόδ' ἔστ' ἀληθές νῦν ἐμοί.
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | - - ~ -

ΣΕΛΗΝΗ

266 τί δῆτα νῦν πρόσω φέρει τὸ πρᾶγμα γε;
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ x

ΓΑΙΑ

267 μορφὴν ἀμείβει πᾶν γένος διὰ χρόνου.
 - - ~ - | - - ~ - | - - ~ -

268 χέρσον δὲ δένδρα, θήρας, ὄρνιθας τρέφειν·
 - - ~ - | - - ~ - | - - ~ -

269 ὄψει δὲ χεῖρας ὄμματ' ἡδὲ καὶ στόμα,
 - - ~ - | - - ~ - | ~ - ~ -

270 καὶ νοῦν ὃς αὐτὸν εἰδέναι δοκεῖ μόνος.
 - - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ x

ΣΕΛΗΝΗ

271 ἄρ' δεινόν ἐστιν ἐκεῖνο πρὶν ὅπερ γ' ἔφη;
 - - ~ - | ~ ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -

272 ὃ πρόσθεν εἶπας ὡς ποτ' ἦξοι εἰς βροτούς;
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | - - ~ x

ΑΝΑΓΚΗ

273 οὐπω· τόδ' ἀρχὴ τῶν κακῶν μόνον ἐστίν.
 - - ~ - | - - ~ - | ~ ~ ~ x

ΣΕΛΗΝΗ

274 τί δῆτα δεινότερον βίου γενήσεται;
 - - ~ - | ~ ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -

ΑΝΑΓΚΗ

275 σαφῶς μαθεῖν θανεῖν σε πρὶν θανεῖν ποτέ.
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ x

NECESSITY

265 You speak aright; this now appears the truer
 thought.
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | - - ~ -

SELENE

266 Then what shall this unfolding action bring to
 pass?
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ x

EARTH

267 Each form of life transforms its shape throughout
 all time.
 - - ~ - | - - ~ - | - - ~ -

268 Dry land shall feed the trees, the beasts, the birds
 of air;
 - - ~ - | - - ~ - | - - ~ -

269 You shall behold their hands, their eyes, their
 speaking mouth:
 - - ~ - | - - ~ - | ~ - ~ -

270 A mind believing only it can know itself.
 - - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ x

SELENE

271 Is this the terror you spoke of in the days before,
 - - ~ - | ~ ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -

272 Which you once said would one day spread
 through mortal kind?
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | - - ~ x

NECESSITY

273 Not yet; this only marks the birth of coming woes.
 - - ~ - | - - ~ - | ~ ~ ~ x

SELENE

274 What then, more fearful than life itself, will yet
 be born?
 - - ~ - | ~ ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -

NECESSITY

275 To know full well that you shall die, before you die.
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ x

(σιγή.)

ΘΑΝΑΤΟΣ

276 τότε αὖ τὸ πρῶτον κρατῶ γένος βροτῶν ὅλον.
 ~ - ~ - | ~ ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ x

ΣΕΛΗΝΗ

277 σὺ δ' οὐ κρατεῖς τὸ πᾶν γένος βροτῶν νυνί;
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ x

ΘΑΝΑΤΟΣ

278 νῦν οὐδὲν ἄλλο πλὴν τὸ σῶμα λαμβάνω·
 -- ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ x

279 φρενῶν κρατήσω, πρὶν βροτὸς δέμας λίπη.
 ~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ x

ΓΑΙΑ

280 τί δῆτα δράσει ζῶον εἰδὸς ὡς θανεῖ;
 -- ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ -

ΑΝΑΓΚΗ

281 θεοὺς πλάσει κατ' εἰκόνας βροτῶν ὁ νοῦς.
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ x

ΑΝΑΓΚΗ

282 θεοὺς βροτὸς τεύξει γ' ὅταν θανεῖν μάθῃ.
 ~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ -

ΣΕΛΗΝΗ

283 θεοὺς; τίς ἂν θνητὸς θεοὺς πλάσαι θέλοι;
 ~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ -

ΑΝΑΓΚΗ

284 ὃς θνητὸς ὢν, θεοὺς ἀθανάτους ποθεῖ.
 -- ~ - | ~ - ~ - | -- ~ -

(silence.)

DEATH

276 Then I shall rule all creatures born into mortal life.
 ~ - ~ - | ~ ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ x

SELENE

277 Do you not rule the race of mortals even now?
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ x

DEATH

278 Now only mortal bodies fall beneath my rule;
 -- ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ x

279 The mind of man I'll rule, before I take his flesh!
 ~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ x

EARTH

280 Indeed, what will a creature do that knows it dies?
 -- ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ -

NECESSITY

281 The mind shall fashion gods in mortal form one day.
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ x

NECESSITY

282 Indeed, man shall make gods when first he learns of death.
 ~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ -

SELENE

283 Ah, gods? What man would wish to bring new gods to birth?
 ~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ -

NECESSITY

284 He who, since mortal, longs for the immortal life.
 -- ~ - | ~ - ~ - | -- ~ -

ΘΑΝΑΤΟΣ

285 φοβούμενος μείζον τεκεῖ ἐμοῦ κάμει.
 ~ - ~ - | - - ~ - | ~ - ~ ~

ΓΑΙΑ

286 τίς πρῶτος αὐτοῖς ἐν φρεσὶν φανήσεται;
 - - ~ - | - - ~ - | - - ~ -

(πῦρ ἀμυδρὸν ἐκ τοῦ βάθους ἀναφαίνεται.)

ΑΝΑΓΚΗ

287 ὁδ' ἐστίν, ὡς ἔοικεν· οὐπω δ' ὄνομα ἔχει.
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | - ~ ~ ~ -

ΣΕΛΗΝΗ

288 τίς οὗτος; ἀφανὴς γὰρ ὄμμασιν πέλει.
 - - ~ - | - - ~ - | - - ~ -

ΑΝΑΓΚΗ

289 οὐδ' ἔσχε μορφὴν μίαν ἐν χρόνῳ μακρῷ.
 - - ~ - | - - ~ - | ~ - ~ -

ΣΕΛΗΝΗ

290 ξένος μὲν ἐστὶ· πρὸς θεῶν κόσμον μολεῖ.
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | - - ~ x

ΑΝΑΓΚΗ

291 οὐπω βροτοὶ θεὸν νιν ἡγοῦνται ποτέ·
 - - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | - - ~ x

292 Τιτὰν νέος μὲν· ὁψὲ δ' ἦλθον οἱ βροτοί·
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ x

293 βροτοὶ θεοὺς καλοῦσιν ὕστερόν ποτε.
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ x

ΓΑΙΑ

294 αὐτὸς λέγοι μοι· τίς ποτ' ὦν πάρεστι νῦν;
 - - ~ - | - - ~ - | ~ - ~ x

DEATH

285 From fear, he will beget one greater than me.
 ~ - ~ - | - - ~ - | ~ - ~ ~

EARTH

286 Which god shall first take shape within man's
 mortal mind?
 - - ~ - | - - ~ - | - - ~ -

(a dim fire appears from the depths.)

NECESSITY

287 This is the one, it seems; as yet he has no name
 now.
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | - ~ ~ ~ -

SELENE

288 And now, who is he? He remains unseen to eyes.
 - - ~ - | - - ~ - | - - ~ -

NECESSITY

289 He never kept one form throughout long ages
 past.
 - - ~ - | - - ~ - | ~ - ~ -

SELENE

290 A stranger comes to dwell among great gods on
 high.
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | - - ~ x

NECESSITY

291 No mortal yet regards him as a god at all;
 - - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | - - ~ x

292 A younger Titan; mortal men came after him.
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ x

293 The mortal race will name the gods in later times.
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ x

EARTH

294 Now, let him tell me who he is—this stranger here.
 - - ~ - | - - ~ - | ~ - ~ x

(ὁ ΞΕΝΟΣ ἐκ τοῦ σκούτους προβαίνει.)

ΞΕΝΟΣ

- 295 οὐκ ἐκ θεῶν ἔφυν· θεοὶ γὰρ ὕστεροι.
-- ~ - | ~ - ~ - | -- ~ x
- 296 μνήμην ἔχω, νοῦ καὶ λόγου πάροιθεν ὦν·
-- ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ x
- 297 ἄνους μὲν ἢ μνήμη, τὸ δ' ἶχνος ἄφθιτον.
~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ x
- 298 πρὶν γλῶσσα φωνὴν ἐκ φρενῶν ἄνω φέρη,
-- ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ x
- 299 πῦρ οὐκ ἔδωκα· πῦρ βροτῶν πάροιθεν ἦν·
-- ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -
- 300 ἐγὼ παρῆν ἄφωνος, ἄγνωστος, κρυφός.
~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | -- ~ x

ΣΕΛΗΝΗ

- 301 τίς εἶ; πόθεν δὲ μνήμα τηλικοῦδ' ἔχεις;
-- ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ x

ΞΕΝΟΣ

- 302 μνήμην δι' αἵματος ἐν σώμασιν ἔσπειρα.
-- ~ - | ~ ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ x

ΘΑΝΑΤΟΣ

- 303 πρὶν νοῦν βροτοῖσι καὶ θεῶν φόβον μολεῖν;
-- ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ x

ΞΕΝΟΣ

- 304 δεσμὸς γενεῶν γέγονα, οὐ σιδήρεος·
-- ~ - | ~ ~ ~ - | ~ - ~ x
- 305 ὁ κόσμος αὐτὸν πρῶτον ἐμιμήσατο,
~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ x
- 306 ἐμὴν ἀνοιξεν ἀτραπὸν πρὸς τὸν χρόνον.
~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | -- ~ ~

(the STRANGER steps out of the darkness.)

STRANGER

- 295 I was not born of gods; the gods came after me.
-- ~ - | ~ - ~ - | -- ~ x
- 296 I hold remembrance from before both mind
and speech;
-- ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ x
- 297 Remembrance has no mind; its trace shall never
die.
~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ x
- 298 Long ere the tongue could draw a voice up from
the mind,
-- ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ x
- 299 Fire was no gift of mine; it lived before mankind;
-- ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ x
- 300 I stood unknown, without a voice, concealed
from all.
~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | -- ~ x

SELENE

- 301 Who are you? Whence do you now hold so great
a sign?
-- ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ x

STRANGER

- 302 Through blood, I sowed remembrance deep
within living flesh.
-- ~ - | ~ ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ x

DEATH

- 303 Before man's mind arose, before his fear of gods?
-- ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ x

STRANGER

- 304 I bind the generations; not with iron chain;
-- ~ - | ~ ~ ~ - | ~ - ~ x
- 305 The world at first fashioned an image of itself,
~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ x
- 306 And opened my own pathway through the
course of time.
~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | -- ~ ~

307 σφάλμα δ' ἕτερον γένος καινὸν ἔτικτε·

-- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ x

308 τέχνη δ' ἡ πρώτη, δι' ἀλλαγῆς μόνον μένειν.

-- ˘ - | ˘ ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ x

ΑΝΑΓΚΗ

309 ξένος παλαιὸς εἶ, πάροιθεν ἡμῶν ὦν.

˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ x

ΞΕΝΟΣ

310 μνήμη πρὸ νοῦ· κλῆσις δὲ γίγνεται χρόνῳ·

-- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

311 κινεῖ δ' ἀκίνητος, βροτοῖς ἀθάνατος.

-- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ ˘

312 διὰ θανάτου πρὸς ἕτερον βαίνει γένος·

-- ˘ - | - ˘ ˘ ˘ - | -- ˘ ˘

313 σῶμα φθίνει· τὸ δ' ἵχνος οὐκ ἀπόλλυται.

-- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ -

ΓΑΙΑ

314 ζῶν ἄρ' αὐτὴν αἰνίσσῃ λέγων τάδε;

˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ x

ΞΕΝΟΣ

315 ζῶν μὲν οὐ· νεκροῦ δέ τι διαμένει.

˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ x

ΧΟΡΟΣ ΝΥΚΤΩΝ

316 καὶ τοῦτό γε σὺ σαυτὸν καλεῖς, ὦ ξένε;

-- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ x

317 σὸν ἔργον εἶη δὴ σαφῶς λέγειν τάδε.

˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ x

ΞΕΝΟΣ

318 σώματα μὲν πολλὰ κατέλιπον ἐν χρόνῳ.

-- ˘ - | -- ˘ ˘ ˘ | ˘ - ˘ -

307 Another error bore a new and different race;

-- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ x

308 its primal art: to live by changing, and still endure.

-- ˘ - | ˘ ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ x

NECESSITY

309 Stranger, you came here before the rest of us.

- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ x

STRANGER

310 Memory came before mind; naming grew with time;

-- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

311 Unmoved yet moving, deathless among mortal men.

-- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ ˘

312 Through death, it passes onward into another race:

-- ˘ - | - ˘ ˘ ˘ - | -- ˘ ˘

313 The body fades; the trace itself is never lost.

-- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ -

EARTH

314 Do you then speak in riddles here of life itself?

˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ x

STRANGER

315 Not life; but something of the dead survives in time.

˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ x

CHORUS OF NIGHTS

316 And is this, stranger what you call yourself, oh, then?

-- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ x

317 Your task should be to make your meaning clear to us.

˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ x

STRANGER

318 Across the ages, I left many bodies behind.

-- ˘ - | -- ˘ ˘ ˘ | ˘ - ˘ -

319 μορφήν ἀμείβω, σπέρμα δ' οὐδέποτε θνήσκει·

-- ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ ~ ~ - x

320 ἐν πόντῳ πρῶτον, αὖ γῆ, τέλος δ' αἰθέρι·

-- ~ - | ~ - ~ - | -- ~ x

321 ξένος ἐν σώμασιν, αὐτὸς δ' αἰὲν μένω.

~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ x

322 πτεροῖς πέτομαι, ποσσὶ δ' ἐν χθονὶ πατῶ.

~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ -

323 πρὶν ὄμμα φῶς γινῶναι, βλέπων παρῆν ἐγώ,

-- ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ -

324 χεῖρά τ' ἔλαβον πρὶν λαβεῖν τι χειρὶ μου·

-- ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ -

325 οὕτως δ' ἀνίσταται γένος πρὸς οὐρανόν,

~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ x

326 καὶ πῦρ ἰδὼν τὸ πρῶτον οὐ φεύγει φόβῳ.

-- ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -

ΣΕΛΗΝΗ

327 ἄνθρωπον αἰνίσσῃ γε τόνδε, τὸν θνητόν.

-- ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ -- ~

328 πῦρ ἄρ' ἔδωκας, ὥς βροτῶν μῦθος λέγει;

-- ~ - | ~ - ~ - | -- ~ -

ΞΕΝΟΣ

329 βροτοὶ δ' ἐν πυρὶ μ' ὄψονται· πῦρ δ' οὐκ ἐγώ.

~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ -

ΣΕΛΗΝΗ

330 πῶς οὖν πυρὸς σὺ δῶρον ἀνθρώποις νέμεις;

-- ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ -

ΧΟΡΟΣ ΝΥΚΤΩΝ

331 τῷ μὴ φυγεῖν πῦρ, χεῖρά τ' ἐκτείνειν πυρί;

-- ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ x

ΞΕΝΟΣ

332 οὐ πῦρ ἔδωκα χερσὶ· τοῦτο γὰρ πάρος.

-- ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ ~

319 I change my form; the seed within can never
perish:

-- ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ ~ ~ - x

320 First in the sea, then earth, and finally the air;

-- ~ - | ~ - ~ - | -- ~ x

321 A stranger in all bodies, I remain myself.

~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ x

322 On wings, I fly; on feet, I tread upon the earth.

~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ -

323 Before the eye knew light, I was already there;

-- ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ -

324 I gripped a hand, before my own hand could
grant aid;

-- ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ -

325 Thus does the race of mortal man rise to the sky,

~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ x

326 And sees the primal fire, and does not flee in
fear.

-- ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -

SELENE

327 You speak in riddles of this creature: mortal man.

-- ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ -- ~

328 Did you then give them fire, as mortal legend
says?

-- ~ - | ~ - ~ - | -- ~ -

STRANGER

329 Mortals shall see me in fire; I am not fire.

~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ -

SELENE

330 How then do you bestow the gift of fire on man?

-- ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ -

CHORUS OF NIGHTS

331 By not fleeing the fire, but stretching forth a
hand?

-- ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ x

STRANGER

332 I gave no fire to hands; the fire was there before.

-- ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ ~

333 πρῶτον πυρὸς φόβον νικᾶν ἔμαθε βροτός·

-- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ ˘

334 πῦρ γὰρ ὑπῆρχε· χεὶρ δ' ἐτόλμησεν μένειν.

-- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ -

335 χρεία δ' ἔτικτε τέχνας ἐκ χειρὸς βροτοῦ.

-- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ -

336 ἀριθμὸς ἐκ μνήμης, γραφή δ' ἔξω μένει.

-- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ -

337 μαντεία γίγνεται βροτοῖς ἐκ δείματος.

-- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ ˘

(σιγή.)

ΧΟΡΟΣ ΝΥΚΤΩΝ

338 ἄρ' οὖν φέρει τὸ σπέρμα σὸν τάδ', ὦ ξένε;

-- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ ×

ΞΕΝΟΣ

339 οἰωνὸς ἐκ φόβου θανάτου φύεται·

-- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ -

340 τὸ μέλλον ἐρευνᾷ, μὴ γινώσκων τέλος.

˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ ×

ΧΟΡΟΣ ΝΥΚΤΩΝ

341 τί δῆτα τούτων ἔργον ἦν σὸν, ὦ ξένε;

-- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ ˘

ΞΕΝΟΣ

342 οὐχ ἓν τὸ ἔργον· διὰ χρόνου γὰρ μένω.

-- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ ×

ΓΑΙΑ

343 ἐν πᾶσιν ἦσθα σπέρμα, κοῦ θεὸς πέλων.

-- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

333 At first, man learned how to conquer his own

fear of fire;

-- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ ˘

334 The fire already burned; the hand dared to

remain.

-- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ -

335 Necessity then brought forth arts, in mortal

hands.

-- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ -

336 Numbering springs from mem'ry; writing stays

outside.

-- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ -

337 Prophecy rises among mortals out of fear.

-- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ ˘

(silence.)

CHORUS OF NIGHTS

338 Does your seed, then, bear all these things, O

stranger?

-- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ ×

STRANGER

339 Each omen rises from mankind's own fear of death:

-- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ -

340 It probes the future, knowing nothing of its end.

˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ ×

CHORUS OF NIGHTS

341 Which one of all these deeds, then, was, O, yours,

stranger?

-- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ ˘

STRANGER

342 No single work is mine; I last through all of time.

-- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ ×

EARTH

343 In all things you were seed, although you were

no god.

-- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

ΞΕΝΟΣ

344 παντοῦ πάρεμι, κἄν ὁ πρῶτος ᾗ νεκρός.
 ~ _ ~ _ | ~ _ ~ _ | ~ _ ~ ~

ΓΑΙΑ

345 βροτοί ποτε κλήσουσί σε Προμηθέα.
 ~ _ ~ _ | -- ~ _ | ~ _ ~ ~ x

ΠΡΟΜΗΘΕΥΣ

346 ὄνομα μὲν ὕστερον· φύσις δ' ἐμὴ πρὶν ἦν·
 ~ ~ ~ ~ _ | ~ _ ~ _ | -- ~ _

347 ἔξω δὲ παντὸς σώματος μνήμη μένει·
 -- ~ _ | -- ~ _ | -- ~ _

ΑΝΑΓΚΗ

348 ὅταν βροτοῖς τὸ αὔριον πρῶτον φανῇ,
 ~ _ ~ _ | ~ _ ~ _ | -- ~ _

349 φόβος θανάτου μέτρον ἐστὶ τοῦ χρόνου.
 ~ _ ~ _ | -- ~ _ | -- ~ _

ΘΑΝΑΤΟΣ

350 καὶ τοῦτο δεινόν· μεῖζον οὐδὲν ἔσσεται.
 -- ~ _ | -- ~ _ | ~ _ ~ _

ΣΕΛΗΝΗ

351 σὺ κατέδειξας πρῶτος αὐτοῖς αὔριον
 -- ~ _ | -- ~ _ | -- ~ ~

352 θεοὺς τέξειν, νόμους τε καὶ πόλεις βροτῶν,
 ~ _ ~ _ | ~ _ ~ _ | ~ _ ~ _

353 γραφὴν τ', ὅπως λαοῖς ἅπασι μὴ συνθάνῃ.
 ~ _ ~ _ | ~ _ ~ ~ ~ | -- ~ _

354 παλαιὸς ὅμως μῦθος σε πάντα φιλεῖν
 ~ _ ~ _ | -- ~ _ | -- ~ _

355 λέγει, χάριν δὲ τῶνδε πῆματ' αὖ φέρειν.
 ~ _ ~ _ | ~ _ ~ _ | ~ _ ~ _

STRANGER

344 I shall be there, although the first men may be
 ~ _ ~ _ | ~ _ ~ _ | ~ _ ~ ~
 dead.

EARTH

345 The mortal race shall one day call you "*Promithéfs*".
 ~ _ ~ _ | -- ~ _ | ~ _ ~ ~ x

PROMETHEUS

346 The name comes later, but my nature was yet
 ~ ~ ~ ~ _ | ~ _ ~ _ | -- ~ _
 there;

347 Outside the mortal body, memory remains!
 -- ~ _ | -- ~ _ | -- ~ _

NECESSITY

348 When mortals first become aware of days to come,
 ~ _ ~ _ | ~ _ ~ _ | -- ~ _

349 The fear of death is what gives measure to their
 ~ _ ~ _ | -- ~ _ | -- ~ _
 time!

DEATH

350 This too is dreadful; nothing greater is to come.
 -- ~ _ | -- ~ _ | ~ _ ~ _

SELENE

351 You were the first to show tomorrow to mankind.
 -- ~ _ | -- ~ _ | -- ~ ~

352 From this shall spring their gods, their laws,
 ~ _ ~ _ | ~ _ ~ _ | ~ _ ~ _
 their cities too;

353 And writing, lest it perish when all of mankind
 ~ _ ~ _ | ~ _ ~ ~ ~ | -- ~ _
 dies.

354 Yet ancient legend says that once you loved them
 ~ _ ~ _ | -- ~ _ | -- ~ _
 all,

355 And says that for their sake you bore a host of
 ~ _ ~ _ | ~ _ ~ _ | ~ _ ~ _
 griefs.

ΠΡΟΜΗΘΕΥΣ

- 356 φιλεῖν μὲν οὐκ οἶδ'· ἐν γένει δ' ἀεὶ μένω·
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ -
- 357 εἰ δὴ θανεῖν θνητοὶ σαφῶς γνοῖέν ποτε...
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ x

ΣΕΛΗΝΗ

- 358 εἰ δ' ἤδεσαν τί θανάτου πέραν μένει,
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -
- 359 οὐκ ἂν λίθους ἔστησαν εἰς μνήμην χρόνου.
 ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -
- 360 τί δῆτα κρύψεις ἐν φρεσὶ βροτῶν ποτε;
 ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ x
- 361 Ζεὺς οὖν ὁ δήσας σοῦ κρατεῖ καὶ νῦν ἔτι;
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ x
- 362 δεσμοὺς δὲ τούτους ψευδέας καλεῖς, ξένε;
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ x

ΠΡΟΜΗΘΕΥΣ

- 363 οὐ δῆτα· δεσμοὶ γνήσιοι πεφύκασιν.
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ x

ΧΟΡΟΣ ΝΥΚΤΩΝ

- 364 οὐ δῶρον, ἀλλὰ χῶρος ἐς τὸ αὔριον.
 -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ x

ΠΡΟΜΗΘΕΥΣ

- 365 δι' αἵματος δὲ θνητὸν οἰκῶ νῦν δέμας.
 ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ x
- 366 ὅστοις δὲ φρουρὸς ἐγκατοικῶ τοῦ γένους.
 -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ -
- 367 οὐ πῦρ δίδωμι· τόλμαν δ', ὥς μὴ πῦρ φυγεῖν.
 -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ -

PROMETHEUS

- 356 I know not love; yet I abide in mortal men.
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ -
- 357 If mortals ever knew, with certainty, they'd die...
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ x

SELENE

- 358 Ah, if they knew what lies beyond the gates of death,
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -
- 359 They would not raise their stones to make remembrance last.
 ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -
- 360 What, then, will you conceal within their minds one day?
 ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ x
- 361 Does Zeus, who bound you, rule you even to this day?
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ x
- 362 And do you call these bonds deceitful, stranger?
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ x

PROMETHEUS

- 363 Not so; these bonds are true; their nature makes them so.
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

CHORUS OF NIGHTS

- 364 No gift, but space in which tomorrow may unfold.
 -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

PROMETHEUS

- 365 Through blood, I now inhabit man's own mortal frame.
 ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ x
- 366 Within their bones I dwell, the guardian of their race.
 -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ -
- 367 I give no fire, but courage not to flee the flame.
 -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ -

368 φόβου κρατοῦντες χεῖρας ἐκτενοῦσι νῦν.
 ~ - ~ - | - - ~ - | ~ - ~ -

369 ἕκαστον αὐτῶν σῶμα θνήσκει πρὸς χρόνον·
 ~ - ~ - | - - ~ - | - - ~ -

370 διὰ θανάτου εἰς γένος πορεύονται.
 - - ~ - | - - ~ - | ~ - ~ -

ΧΟΡΟΣ ΝΥΚΤΩΝ

371 τίς Ζηνὸς ὄρνις ἦπαρ αἰμάσσει πάλιν;
 - - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | - - ~ ×

ΠΡΟΜΗΘΕΥΣ

372 Λήθη· γένος γὰρ πᾶν τὸ πρόσθεν λησμονεῖ.
 - - ~ - | - - ~ - | - - ~ -

373 μαντεία βλαστάνει βροτοῖσιν ἐκ φόβου.
 - - ~ - | - - ~ - | - - ~ -

374 γόνος νεώτερος τὸ πρόσθεν αὖ ποθεῖ,
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -

375 θεοὺς δὲ πλάσσει πρὸς φυγὴν παντὸς δέους.
 ~ - ~ - | - - ~ - | - - ~ ×

368 They master fear, and now stretch hands
 wards its warmth.
 ~ - ~ - | - - ~ - | ~ - ~ -

369 Each one of their frail bodies dies within its time;
 ~ - ~ - | - - ~ - | - - ~ -

370 Through death, they journey onward to another
 race.
 - - ~ - | - - ~ - | ~ - ~ -

CHORUS OF NIGHTS

371 Which bird of Zeus returns to rend your liver
 now?
 - - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | - - ~ ×

PROMETHEUS

372 Oblivion: each race forgets what came before.
 - - ~ - | - - ~ - | - - ~ -

373 The art of prophecy grows in mankind from
 fear.
 - - ~ - | - - ~ - | - - ~ -

374 Each younger generation longs for what came
 first,
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ -

375 And fashions gods in flight from every form of
 dread.
 ~ - ~ - | - - ~ - | - - ~ ×

ΣΤΑΣΙΜΟΝ Γ΄

ΧΟΡΟΣ ΝΥΚΤΩΝ

ΑΣΤΡΟΦΟΝ ΜΕΛΟΣ

- 376 ὁ θνητὸς αὐτὸν γνούς, ἀθανάτους ποθεῖ.
x – ˘ – | x – ˘ – | x – ˘ –
- 377 οὐ βράχοις δέδεταί,
– ˘ – | – ˘ –
- 378 οὐδὲ σίδηρος γυῖα περισφίγγει,
– ˘ ˘ – | – ˘ ˘ – | – ˘ –
- 379 οὐδ' ἐν Καυκάσου κορυφαῖς στενάζει·
– ˘ ˘ – | – ˘ ˘ – | – ˘ –
- 380 δεσμοὶ δ' αὐτῷ γίνονται αἶμα, σάρκες, ὅστέα.
– ˘ ˘ – | – ˘ ˘ – | – ˘ ˘ – | – –
- 381 σῶμα δ' αὐτῷ ζῶσα πέδη πέφυκεν,
– ˘ ˘ – | – ˘ ˘ – | – ˘ –
- 382 γένος δὲ μακρὰν ἄλυσιν ἐξυφαίνει·
– ˘ ˘ – | – ˘ ˘ – | – ˘ ˘ –
- 383 χρόνος δ' ἀκοίμητος,
– ˘ – | – ˘ –
- 384 φρουρὸς ἐφεστὼς πάντα λεύσσει.
– ˘ – | – ˘ – | – ˘ –
- 385 θνήσκει μὲν πᾶν σῶμα,
– ˘ – | – ˘ –
- 386 ἄσβεστον δ' ἵχνος διαμένει·
– ˘ – | – ˘ – | – ˘ –
- 387 ἄλλο δὲ σῶμα τοῦτο δέχεται,
– ˘ ˘ – | – ˘ ˘ – | ˘ –
- 388 θανὸν δὲ δέμας νέῳ τόπον παραχωρεῖ·
˘ – ˘ ˘ – | ˘ – ˘ ˘ – | ˘ ˘ – –
- 389 οὕτως ἐκ πρώτου βυθοῦ βίος ἀναθρόσκει·
– ˘ ˘ – | – ˘ ˘ – | – ˘ ˘ – | –
- 390 οὕτως κόσμος μεταβάλλων διαμένει.
– ˘ ˘ – | – ˘ ˘ – | – ˘ ˘ –
- 391 μία δὲ μακρὰ μνήμη διὰ γενῶν ῥεῖ.
– ˘ ˘ – | – ˘ ˘ – | – ˘ ˘ –

STASIMON III

CHORUS OF NIGHTS

ASTROPHIC SONG

- 376 The mortal, knowing self, desires deathless
gods.
x – ˘ – | x – ˘ – | x – ˘ –
- 377 No rocks now bind him fast,
– ˘ – | – ˘ –
- 378 Nor iron winds its fetters about his limbs,
– ˘ ˘ – | – ˘ ˘ – | – ˘ –
- 379 Nor does he groan upon the Caucasus
heights;
– ˘ ˘ – | – ˘ ˘ – | – ˘ –
- 380 Blood, flesh, and bones become the bonds
that hold his being fast.
– ˘ ˘ – | – ˘ ˘ – | – ˘ ˘ – | – –
- 381 His body is itself a living fetter,
– ˘ ˘ – | – ˘ ˘ – | – ˘ –
- 382 His lineage weaves him a long enduring
chain;
– ˘ ˘ – | – ˘ ˘ – | – ˘ ˘ –
- 383 Time, sleepless, without rest,
– ˘ – | – ˘ –
- 384 Guarding above him, beholding all.
– ˘ – | – ˘ – | – ˘ –
- 385 All bodies die in time,
– ˘ – | – ˘ –
- 386 Yet the unquenched trace remains alive;
– ˘ – | – ˘ – | – ˘ –
- 387 Another body takes this trace within;
– ˘ ˘ – | – ˘ ˘ – | ˘ –
- 388 A body, dead, gives place to one that is newly
born;
˘ – ˘ ˘ – | ˘ – ˘ ˘ – | ˘ ˘ – –
- 389 Thus from the primal deep, life suddenly springs
upward;
– ˘ ˘ – | – ˘ ˘ – | – ˘ ˘ – | –
- 390 Thus does the world endure, by ever changing
form.
– ˘ ˘ – | – ˘ ˘ – | – ˘ ˘ –
- 391 One long memory flows, through generations.
– ˘ ˘ – | – ˘ ˘ – | – ˘ ˘ –

392 διὰ θανάτων βίος εἰς βίον διαβαίνει.
 - ˘ ˘ - | - ˘ ˘ - | - ˘ ˘ - | --

392 Through death, life passes onward into ever
 newer life.

- ˘ ˘ - | - ˘ ˘ - | - ˘ ˘ - | --

ΕΠΕΙΣΟΔΙΟΝ Δ΄

ΘΑΝΑΤΟΣ

393 ἐν δ' οὐκ ἔλεξας· τί βροτοῖς δῶρον φέρεις;
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ -

394 πῶς γὰρ ἐμέ γνοῖέν γ' ἄνευ φόβου ποτέ;
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ ×

ΠΡΟΜΗΘΕΥΣ

395 ἔδωκα τούτοις φάρμακον μέγα φρενῶν.
 ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

ΘΑΝΑΤΟΣ

396 λύσιν θανάτου οὔτοι δίδως· τί νῦν φέρεις;
 ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

ΠΡΟΜΗΘΕΥΣ

397 θνητούς γ' ἔπαυσα μὴ προδέρκεσθαι μόρον.
 -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ ×

ΣΕΛΗΝΗ

398 τὸ ποῖον εὐρῶν τῆσδε φάρμακον νόσου;
 ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

ΠΡΟΜΗΘΕΥΣ

399 χρόνον θανεῖν ἔκρυψα ἐκ πάντων νοῶν.
 ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

ΘΑΝΑΤΟΣ

400 ψευδῇ λέγεις;
 -- ˘ - |

ΠΡΟΜΗΘΕΥΣ

401 οὐ δῆτα σοι ψευδῇ λέγω.
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ -

402 τυφλὰς ἐν αὐτοῖς ἐλπίδας κατώκισα.
 ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ ×

EPISODE IV

DEATH

393 One thing you have not said: what gift do you
 bring men?

-- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ -

394 How could they ever know me and be free of fear?
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ ×

PROMETHEUS

395 I gave to them a great remedy for the mind.
 ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

DEATH

396 You grant no release from death; what do you
 bring forth then?

˘ - ˘ - | ˘ ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

PROMETHEUS

397 I made the mortal race cease to foresee its doom.
 -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ ×

SELENE

398 What kind of cure did you devise for this disease?
 ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

PROMETHEUS

399 I hid the hour of death away from every mind.
 ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

DEATH

400 You speak falsely?
 -- ˘ - |

PROMETHEUS

401 No; I speak no falsehood to
 you.

-- ˘ - | -- ˘ -

402 Blind hopes I made to dwell within the minds
 of men.

˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ ×

ΣΕΛΗΝΗ

403 πῶς δὴ ἀνὴρ θανεῖν ποτ' οἶδεν, ζῶν ὅμως;
 -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

ΠΡΟΜΗΘΕΥΣ

404 θανεῖν μὲν οἶδε· τὸν χρόνον δ' οὐκ οἶδέ πω·
 ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ -

405 οὐδ' εἴ τι θανάτου πέραν αὐτῷ μένει.
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ -

406 ἐν τῷ μεταξύ δ' οἰκίαν τεκταίνεται,
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ -

407 παῖδας φυτεύει, γῆν ἄροῖ, πόντον περᾶ,
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ -

408 πόλεις ἐγείρει, γράμμασι μνήμην δένει.
 ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ -

ΘΑΝΑΤΟΣ

409 ἐμοῦ παρόντος ὡς ἀπόντος ζῇ ἀνὴρ.
 ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ ×

ΠΡΟΜΗΘΕΥΣ

410 καὶ διὰ τοῦτο ζῇ· σὺ δ' εἰ παρὼν ἀεὶ
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ -

411 σαφὴς δ' ἐφαίνου δὴ λαῶν ἐνώπιος,
 ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ ×

412 οὐδεὶς ἂν εἰς αὔριον ἔσπειρε χθονί.
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ -

ΓΑΙΑ

413 σοφόν γε ψεῦδος, εἴπερ βροτοῖς ἔργων γονεὺς.
 ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ -

SELENE

403 How, then, can living men know they must one
 day die?
 -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

PROMETHEUS

404 They know that they will die; the hour they do
 not know;
 ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ -

405 Nor whether something waits for them beyond
 their death.
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ -

406 Between the two, they build themselves a
 dwelling place;
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ -

407 They plant their children, plough the earth, and
 cross the seas;
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ -

408 And cities raise, and bind remembrance into
 script.
 ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ -

DEATH

409 Though I am present, men live as though I were
 gone.
 ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ ×

PROMETHEUS

410 And, thus, they live; but if you always were at
 hand
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ -

411 And clearly showed yourself before the eyes of
 all,
 ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ ×

412 No man would sow the earth in hope of days to
 come.
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ -

EARTH

413 A lie is wise, if among mankind it breeds such
 deeds.
 ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ -

ΑΝΑΓΚΗ

414 οὐ ψευδός ἐστι· δισσὰ δ' ἀγνοεῖ μόνον·
 -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ ×

415 κάκ τοῦδε πᾶν τέχνημα βλαστάνει γένει.
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

ΣΕΛΗΝΗ

416 οὐδ' ἦν μέγιστον σφᾶς πυρὸς λῦσαι φόβου;
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ -

ΠΡΟΜΗΘΕΥΣ

417 ἐμὸν δὲ δῶρον πρῶτον ἦν τὸ αὔριον.
 ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ ×

NECESSITY

414 No lie; there are but two things, hidden from
 his mind;
 -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ ×

415 And from this, every work of skill springs forth
 for man.
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

SELENE

416 So teaching them to face fire was not your
 chief gift?
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ -

PROMETHEUS

417 My foremost gift to humankind was “tomorrow”.
 ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ ×

ΣΤΑΣΙΜΟΝ Δ΄

ΧΟΡΟΣ ΝΥΚΤΩΝ

ΣΤΡΟΦΗ

- 418 ἰὼ βροτέ, βραχύμορ' ὦ γόνε,
 419 ὃς θάνατον εἰδώς·
 420 ὡς ἀθάνατός δὲ μοχθεῖς,
 421 καὶ τᾶδ' ἅλα πάντ' ἀγνοῶν
 422 μέλλοντος ἔνεκα ζῆς.
 423 σπείρεις γ' ἃ μὴ θερίσεις,
 424 πύργους δ' ὑποῖς οὓς καταλείψεις,
 425 γόνους δὲ γενναῖς
 426 οἱ σὲ θάψουσιν.
 427 ὦ τυφλὰ τροφὲ ψυχῶν,
 428 ἄσβεστον φῶς, Ἑλπίς,
 429 σὺ τὸν ζόφον κρύπτεις
 430 ἵνα πόλεις γέναιται.

ΑΝΤΙΣΤΡΟΦΗ

- 431 ἰὼ βροτέ, πολύμοχθ' ὦ γόνε,
 432 ὃς λήθην γε φέρεις,
 433 μνήμην δ' ἀθάνατον κτίζεις,
 434 καὶ τὰ πρόσθεν πάντ' ἀγνοῶν,

STASIMON IV

CHORUS OF NIGHTS

STROPHE

- 418 Ah mortal, child whose assigned life is brief,
 419 —Who, though you know your death,
 420 Still toil as though you could not die—,
 421 though all ahead of you unknown
 422 Still you live for what shall come;
 423 You sow what you shall not reap,
 424 And raise high towers you must forsake;
 425 And you beget sons
 426 Who shall bury you.
 427 O blind nurse of human souls,
 428 Hope, light no death can quench,
 429 You hide the gloom from sight,
 430 So that the cities are born.

ANTISTROPHE

- 431 Ah mortal, child whose portion is long toil
 432 —Who bears forgetfulness,
 433 Yet builds a deathless memory
 434 with all that lie behind unknown—,

435 πρὸς ἀρχὴν αἰεὶ ζητεῖς.
 ~ _ _ ~ _ _ _
 436 γράφεις γ' ἃ καὶ σὺ λήσῃ,
 ~ _ ~ _ | ~ _ _
 437 σήκους δ' ὑποῖς οὓς καταλείψεις,
 _ _ _ _ _ ~ ~ _ _
 438 θεοὺς δὲ γεννᾷς
 ~ _ ~ _ | _
 439 οἱ σ' ἐλέγξουσιν.
 _ ~ _ _ ~
 440 ὦ βαθεῖα τροφὴ νοῦ,
 _ ~ _ _ ~ ~ _
 441 Μνημοσύνη τ' ἄσβεστον πῦρ,
 _ _ _ _ | ~ _ ~
 442 σὺ τὸ σκότος τέμνεις
 ~ _ ~ _ | _ _
 443 ἵνα λόγος γένεται.
 ~ ~ | ~ _ ~ _ | _

ΕΠΩΔΟΣ

444 καὶ πῦρ ἐκ λίθου,
 _ _ | _ ~ _
 445 καὶ λόγος ἐκ χειλέων,
 _ ~ ~ _ | _ ~ _
 446 ἀριθμὸς ἐκ δακτύλων,
 ~ _ ~ _ | _ ~ _
 447 μέλος δ' ἐκ πνοῆς.
 ~ _ | _ ~ _
 448 καὶ, βλέπων ἄνω,
 _ ~ _ | ~ _
 449 ἀνὴρ ἐμέτρησεν ἄστρα,
 ~ _ | ~ ~ _ ~ _ | _ x
 450 κλήσεις δ' ἔδωκε τοῖς
 _ _ | ~ _ ~ _
 451 πρὶν ἀνωνύμοις·
 ~ ~ _ ~ _
 452 Κρόνον μὲν προσεῖπεν,
 ~ _ _ ~ _ x
 453 εἶτα Σελήνην,
 _ ~ ~ _ _
 454 Γαῖαν δὲ μητέρα,
 _ _ ~ _ ~ x

435 You seek the Source forever;
 ~ _ _ ~ _ _ _
 436 You write what you shall forget;
 ~ _ ~ _ | ~ _ _
 437 And now raise shrines you leave behind you;
 _ _ _ _ _ ~ ~ _ _
 438 And you beget gods
 ~ _ ~ _ | _
 439 Who shall pass judgment.
 _ ~ _ _ ~
 440 O deep nurse of mortal mind,
 _ ~ _ _ ~ ~ _
 441 Mnemosyne, oh unquenched fire
 _ _ _ _ | ~ _ ~
 442 You cleave the dark apart,
 ~ _ ~ _ | _ _
 443 So that the word may be born.
 ~ ~ | ~ _ ~ _ | _

EPODE

444 And fire sprung from stone,
 _ _ | _ ~ _
 445 And speech came forth from the lips,
 _ ~ ~ _ | _ ~ _
 446 And numbers then from fingers,
 ~ _ ~ _ | _ ~ _
 447 And song came from breath.
 ~ _ | _ ~ _
 448 And, gazing above,
 _ ~ _ | ~ _
 449 Man took the measure of the stars,
 ~ _ | ~ ~ _ ~ _ | _ x
 450 And gave names to the ones
 _ _ | ~ _ ~ _
 451 Who had none before;
 ~ ~ _ ~ _
 452 He named the great Cronus,
 ~ _ _ ~ _ x
 453 Next came Selene,
 _ ~ ~ _ _
 454 Gaia he called "Mother",
 _ _ ~ _ ~ x

455 Ἀνάγκην τε θεάν·
 ~ _ _ ~ ~ _

456 τῷ δ' ἀγνώστῳ ξένῳ
 _ ~ _ _ ~ _

457 Προμηθεὺς δ' ὄνομ' ἦν.
 ~ _ _ | ~ ~ _

458 μία δ' ἀρχή,
 ~ ~ _ _

459 ἄκλητος μένει·
 ~ _ | _ ~ _

460 ἡ αὐτοῦ.
 _ _ _

455 Necessity, goddess;
 ~ _ _ ~ ~ _

456 The unknown stranger
 _ ~ _ | _ _

457 Prometheus was then named.
 ~ _ _ | ~ ~ _

458 One root alone
 ~ ~ _ _

459 Still remains unnamed:
 ~ _ | _ ~ _

460 His own source.
 _ _ _

ΕΠΕΙΣΟΔΙΟΝ Ε΄

(σιδήρεον ὄχημα, πυρὶ βρυχόμενον, ἐκ γαίης πρὸς οὐρανὸν βιαίως ἀνίσταται.)

ΣΕΛΗΝΗ

461 καὶ νῦν ὁρῶ βροτοὺς πρὸς οὐρανὸν βλέπειν·
 -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ -

462 πάλαι μὲν εὐχὰς ἔπεμπον, αἰτοῦντες θεοῦς,
 -- ˘ - | ˘ ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ -

463 νῦν δ' ἄλλο πῦρ ἔχοντες ἐκ γαίης πέτονται.
 -- ˘ - | ˘ ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ -

GAIA

464 τί δρῶσιν; ἧ μ' ἀτιμάσαντες ἐκλιπεῖν;
 -- ˘ -- | -- ˘ -- | ˘ -- ˘ --

465 τίς ἡ γέφυρα τοῦδε τοῦ μακροῦ χρόνου;
 -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ -

ΠΡΟΜΗΘΕΥΣ

466 οὐ σὲ φυγόντες· ἴχνη σφῶν μαστεύουσιν.
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ x

ΣΕΛΗΝΗ

467 ἦδη γὰρ ἤψαντό μου χερσὶν οἱ γηγενεῖς.
 -- ˘ - | ˘ ˘ -- ˘ - | ˘ -- ˘ x

GAIA

468 τί φής; ἀνδρῶν πόδες σ' ἔθιξαν, ὦ θεά;
 ~ ~ ~ | ~ ~ ~ | ~ ~ ~

469 σὸν σῶμα ψυχρὸν ἦλθον ἄψασθαι φῶτες;
 -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | --- x

EPISODE V

(An iron craft, roaring with fire, rises violently from Earth.)

SELENE

461 And now I see men gaze toward the vault of
heaven.

462 Of old, they sent up prayers, as supplicants
to gods,

463 Now bearing other fire, they fly away from Earth.
 -- ˘ - | ˘ ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ -

EARTH

464 In truth, what do they do? Do they depart in scorn?
 -- ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ ~ -

465 What kind of bridge spans out across this length
of time?

-- ~ -- | ~ ~ -- | -- ~ --

PROMETHEUS

466 They have not fled from you; they seek their own
lost trace.

SELENE

467 For Earth-born hands have already dared to touch
my form!

— — ♪ — | ♪ ♪ — ♪ — | ♪ — ♪ ×

EARTH

468 What? Have the feet of men disgraced your face,
goddess?
˘ ˘ ˘ | ˘ ˘ ˘ | ˘ ˘ ˘

469 Voyagers came to touch your cold and barren
flesh?
-- ~ -- | ~ ~ -- | --- x

ΣΕΛΗΝΗ

470 ἔθιξαν· ἐξ ἐμοῦ δὲ πέτρας γῇ φέρουσιν,
 ~ - ~ - | ~ ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ x

471 χρόνον δ' ἐν αὐταῖς γεγραμμένον σκοποῦσιν.
 ~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ x

ΠΡΟΜΗΘΕΥΣ

472 οὕτως ὁ παῖς πρὸς μητέρα βλέπει ποτέ,
 -- ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ x

473 ζητῶν ἐν ὄψει τῆς τεκούσης τὴν φύσιν.
 -- ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ x

ΑΝΑΓΚΗ

474 πρόσω δ' ἔτι μακρὰν ὁδὸν πορεύσονται.
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | -- ~ -

ΣΕΛΗΝΗ

475 ποῖ δῆτα φῆς;
 -- ~ - |

ΑΝΑΓΚΗ

476 Κρόνου δόμους ἤξουσὶ γε.
 ~ - ~ - | -- ~ ~

(σιγή.)

ΠΡΟΜΗΘΕΥΣ

477 Κρόνον λέγεις;
 ~ - ~ - |

ΑΝΑΓΚΗ

478 πέραν γε, χωροῦντος χρόνου.
 ~ - ~ - | -- ~ -

479 ζόφον τεμεῖ βαθὺν σιδηροῦν ὄμμα νῦν,
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | -- ~ -

480 ἄσαρκον, ἄπνουν, αἶμα δ' οὐδαμῇ φέρον,
 ~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ x

SELENE

470 They touched me, and now bear stones from me
 back to your ground,
 ~ - ~ - | ~ ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ x

471 Seeking in them the written record of deep time;
 ~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ x

PROMETHEUS

472 Thus does a child one day look back toward his
 own source,
 -- ~ - | ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ x

473 Seeking within his mother's face his own true form.
 -- ~ - | -- ~ - | -- ~ x

NECESSITY

474 Still farther on, they shall pursue the longer road!
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | -- ~ -

SELENE

475 Where do you mean?
 -- ~ - |

NECESSITY

476 the hall of Cronus they shall
 reach!
 ~ - ~ - | -- ~ ~

(silence.)

PROMETHEUS

477 Cronus, you say?
 ~ - ~ - |

NECESSITY

478 Beyond, as time itself moves on.
 ~ - ~ - | -- ~ -

479 And now, an iron eye shall cleave the dark apart,
 ~ - ~ - | ~ - ~ - | -- ~ -

480 Fleshless and breathless, bearing not a drop of
 blood,
 ~ - ~ - | -- ~ - | ~ - ~ x

481 ἀλλ' αἴσθησιν καὶ μνήμην τεχνήεσσαν μόνον
 -- ˘ - | ˘ ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ ˘

ΣΕΛΗΝΗ

482 καὶ ταῦτα πάντα δὴ θεάσεται ποτε;
 ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

ΑΝΑΓΚΗ

483 Κρόνου πάγον, κύκλους τε νῦν, νέφη θ' ὄρᾱ·
 ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

484 ξένου παλαιοῦ σύγγονον σαφῶς νοεῖ·
 ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

485 κύκλῳ Κρόνου ζόφῳ βαθεῖ δρόμον τελεῖ.
 ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

ΓΑΙΑ

486 Τιτᾶνα δὴ προσέρχεται;
 ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

ΑΝΑΓΚΗ

487 ναί· νῦν πελᾷ.
 -- ˘ -

ΣΕΛΗΝΗ

488 κάκεῖνος αὐτοῖς συγγενὴς φανήσεται;
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

ΑΝΑΓΚΗ

489 πόντους ξένους, δὴ πυκνὰ νῦν νέφη θ' ὄρᾱ,
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

490 ἀέρα βαρύν, πάγου κεκρυμμένης φλέβας.
 - ˘ ˘ ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

491 ξένῳ παλαιῷ πάντ' ἀδελφὰ φαίνεται.
 ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

481 But sense and memory, both fashioned only by
 art.
 -- ˘ - | ˘ ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ ˘

SELENE

482 Will it one day behold all these things, do say!
 ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

NECESSITY

483 It sees the ice of Cronus, rings, and clouds above,
 ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

484 Clearly discerning the old stranger's own kin.
 ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

485 Round Cronus, through deep gloom, it runs its
 measured course.
 ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

EARTH

486 Does it now draw near to Titan?
 ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

NECESSITY

487 Yes; now it
 nears.
 -- ˘ -

SELENE

488 And will he then appear to them as their own kin?
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

NECESSITY

489 The "eye" sees alien seas, and now the clouds
 grow dense;
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

490 Thick air it sees, and hidden veins of ancient ice;
 - ˘ ˘ ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

491 All things seem kindred to this ancient stranger
 now.
 ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ -

ΠΡΟΜΗΘΕΥΣ

492 μνήμη δὲ νῦν σαφῶς βλέπει ὅθεν πέφυ.
 -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ ×

ΑΝΑΓΚΗ

493 ζήτησις, οὐ μνήμη· τάλιθές πρόσθεν ἦν.
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ -

PROMETHEUS

492 Mem'ry now clearly looks where it once first
 arose.
 -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ ×

NECESSITY

493 Not memory, but search; the truth was there
 before.
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ -

ΕΞΟΔΟΣ

ΣΕΛΗΝΗ

- 494 ὦ Γαῖα, νῦν μοι φαίνεται κύκλος μέγας·
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ -
- 495 πάλαι δὲ πρὸς σ' ὄδ' ἦλθεν, ἐκ Κρόνου, ξένος·
 ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ ×
- 496 τὸ τέκνον ἤδη δὴ ἀφῖκτο πρὸς Κρόνον.
 ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ ×

ΓΑΙΑ

- 497 ἦκει τι φῶς· ἐμὸν γένος νῦν βλαστάνει.
 -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ ×

ΠΡΟΜΗΘΕΥΣ

- 498 καὶ τοῦτο λαμπρόν ἐστι πῦρ βροτῶν νέον.
 -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ ×

ΣΕΛΗΝΗ

- 499 ποῖόν τι πῦρ;
 -- ˘ - |

ΠΡΟΜΗΘΕΥΣ

- 500 βροτοῖς τὸ ζητεῖν φῶς αἰεί.
 ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ ×

ΧΟΡΟΣ ΝΥΚΤΩΝ

ΣΤΡΟΦΗ

- 501 ἀρχὰν ζητεῖ βροτός,
 -- | -- | ˘ ×
- 502 γένος δ' αὐτὸν φέρει·
 ˘ - | -- | ˘ -
- 503 πόρρωθεν ἦλθε ρεῦμα·
 -- ˘ - | ˘ - ×
- 504 ἐκ ρεύματος πνοά,
 -- ˘ - | ˘ ×

EXODOS

SELENE

- 494 O Earth, a mighty circle opens to my sight:
 -- ˘ - | -- ˘ - | -- ˘ -
- 495 This stranger came to you from Cronus long ago;
 ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ ×
- 496 The “child” has reached the side of Cronus by
 this time.
 ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ ×

EARTH

- 497 A light has come; my offspring now begins to
 grow.
 -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ ×

PROMETHEUS

- 498 And this too is a bright new fire for mortal men.
 -- ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ - | ˘ - ˘ ×

SELENE

- 499 What kind of fire?
 -- ˘ - |

PROMETHEUS

- 500 To seek, is man's undying
 light.
 ˘ - ˘ - | -- ˘ ×

CHORUS OF NIGHTS

STROPHE

- 501 Man seeks life's primal source;
 -- | -- | ˘ ×
- 502 His source now carries him.
 ˘ - | -- | ˘ -
- 503 From far away came the stream;
 -- ˘ - | ˘ - ×
- 504 From this stream breath arose
 -- ˘ - | ˘ ×

505 πικρὸν φάρμακον,
 ~ - | - ~ x
 506 ζῶαν δ' ἔτικτε.
 -- | ~ - x
 507 ξένος πρὸς χθόνα
 ~ - | - ~ x
 508 ἄνωθεν ἔπεσεν·
 ~ - ~ | ~ ~ x
 509 ἐξ ἄπνου σώματος
 --- | - ~ x
 510 ἄλμην ἐκόμισεν.
 -- | ~ ~ ~ x

ΑΝΤΙΣΤΡΟΦΗ

511 μοῖραν ζητεῖ βροτός,
 -- | -- | ~ x
 512 τέλος δ' αὐτὸν φέρει·
 ~ - | -- | ~ -
 513 πόρρωθεν ἦλθε σῶμα,
 -- ~ - | ~ - x
 514 ἐκ σώματος θυμός,
 -- ~ - | ~ x
 515 ἐκ φρενὸς δὲ πῦρ
 - ~ - | ~ -
 516 ἄσβεστον ἔφυ.
 -- | ~ ~ x
 517 γόνος πρὸς Κρόνον
 ~ - | - ~ x
 518 κάτωθεν ἀνέβη,
 ~ - ~ | ~ ~ x
 519 ἐκ ζῶντος σώματος
 --- | - ~ x
 520 μνήμην ἐκόμισεν.
 -- | ~ ~ ~ x

ΕΠΩΔΟΣ

521 ὦ Κρόνε, δέξαι
 - ~ ~ | --
 522 Γαίας τόδε τέκνον.
 -- | ~ ~ | - x
 523 οὐκ ἔρχεται κλέψαι·
 -- ~ - | --

505 —A dreadful poison—,
 ~ - | - ~ x
 506 bringing forth all the life.
 -- | ~ - x
 507 A stranger to Earth,
 ~ - | - ~ x
 508 Fell downward from above;
 ~ - ~ | ~ ~ x
 509 From breathless flesh and bone,
 --- | - ~ x
 510 It carried sea-water.
 -- | ~ ~ ~ x

ANTISTROPHE

511 Man seeks Fate's final bound,
 -- | -- | ~ x
 512 His end now carries him;
 ~ - | -- | ~ -
 513 From far away came the flesh,
 -- ~ - | ~ - x
 514 From flesh the will arose,
 -- ~ - | ~ x
 515 From mind grew the flame
 - ~ - | ~ -
 516 —An undying light.
 -- | ~ ~ x
 517 Offspring to Cronus,
 ~ - | - ~ x
 518 Rose upward from below;
 ~ - ~ | ~ ~ x
 519 From living flesh and bone,
 --- | - ~ x
 520 It carried memory.
 -- | ~ ~ ~ x

EPODE

521 Cronus, now receive
 - ~ ~ | --
 522 This child that Gaia bore.
 -- | ~ ~ | - x
 523 He does not come to steal;
 -- ~ - | --

524 μόνον δ' ἐρωτῆσαι
 ~ - | ~ - - x

525 τίς ἦν ὁ ξένος
 ~ - | ~ ~ x

526 ὃς πρὸ χρόνου
 - ~ | ~ -

527 ἐκ σῆς παλαιᾶς ἔδρας
 - - | ~ - - | ~ x

528 πρὸς Γαῖαν ἔπεσεν·
 - - ~ | ~ ~ x

529 τί τ' ἔφερεν ἐν πάγῳ,
 ~ ~ ~ ~ | - ~ -

530 τί δ' ἐν βαρεῖ ὕδατι.
 ~ - | ~ - | ~ ~ x

531 ἄρ' ἐν πικρῷ φαρμάκῳ
 - - | ~ - | - ~ -

532 ἄγνωστον σπέρμα κεῖτο;
 - - - | - ~ | - x

533 κἂν γε ὕστερον
 - ~ | - ~ x

534 βροτὸς μάθῃ σαφῶς
 ~ - | ~ - | ~ -

535 ὅθεν ἐλήλυθεν,
 ~ ~ | ~ - ~ x

536 μὴ τοῦτο θαυμάσης·
 - - ~ | - ~ -

537 πάλαι γάρ,
 ~ - x

538 πρὶν ἄνθρωπον γενέσθαι,
 ~ - - - | ~ - -

539 ὁ κόσμος
 ~ - x

540 πρῶτον
 - x

541 ἑαυτὸν ἐμίμησεν.
 ~ - ~ | ~ ~ - x

ΠΡΟΜΗΘΕΥΣ

542 ἐγὼ δ' ἔως ζωὴ τις ἦ, παρῶν μενῶ.
 ~ - ~ - | - - ~ - | ~ - ~ -

524 But only to ask you
 ~ - | ~ - - x

525 Who the stranger was
 ~ - | ~ ~ x

526 Who, before Time,
 - ~ | ~ -

527 From your primeval throne
 - - | ~ - - | ~ x

528 Fell down upon the Earth;
 - - ~ | ~ ~ x

529 What did he bear sealed in ice?
 ~ ~ ~ ~ | - ~ -

530 What in its heavy water?
 ~ - | ~ - | ~ ~ x

531 Within the bitter poison
 - - | ~ - | - ~ -

532 Did an unknown seed lie there?
 - - - | - ~ | - x

533 If, in later days,
 - ~ | - ~ x

534 Man comes to know at last
 ~ - | ~ - | ~ -

535 From whence he came to be,
 ~ ~ | ~ - ~ x

536 Don't think it a wonder;
 - - ~ | - ~ -

537 Long ago,
 ~ - x

538 Ere mortal man came to be,
 ~ - - - | ~ - -

539 The cosmos
 ~ - x

540 At first
 - x

541 Made a likeness of itself.
 ~ - ~ | ~ ~ - x

PROMETHEUS

542 I shall remain beside all life while life endures.
 ~ - ~ - | - - ~ - | ~ - ~ -

ΘΑΝΑΤΟΣ

543 κάγω.
× –

ΑΝΑΓΚΗ

544 ἐγὼ δὲ πρώτη πάντων εἰμὶ δῆ.
˘ – | ˘ – ˘ – | – – ˘ –

(σκότος.)

DEATH

543 And I.
× –

NECESSITY

544 But I was here before all other beings.
˘ – | ˘ – ˘ – | – – ˘ –

(darkness.)